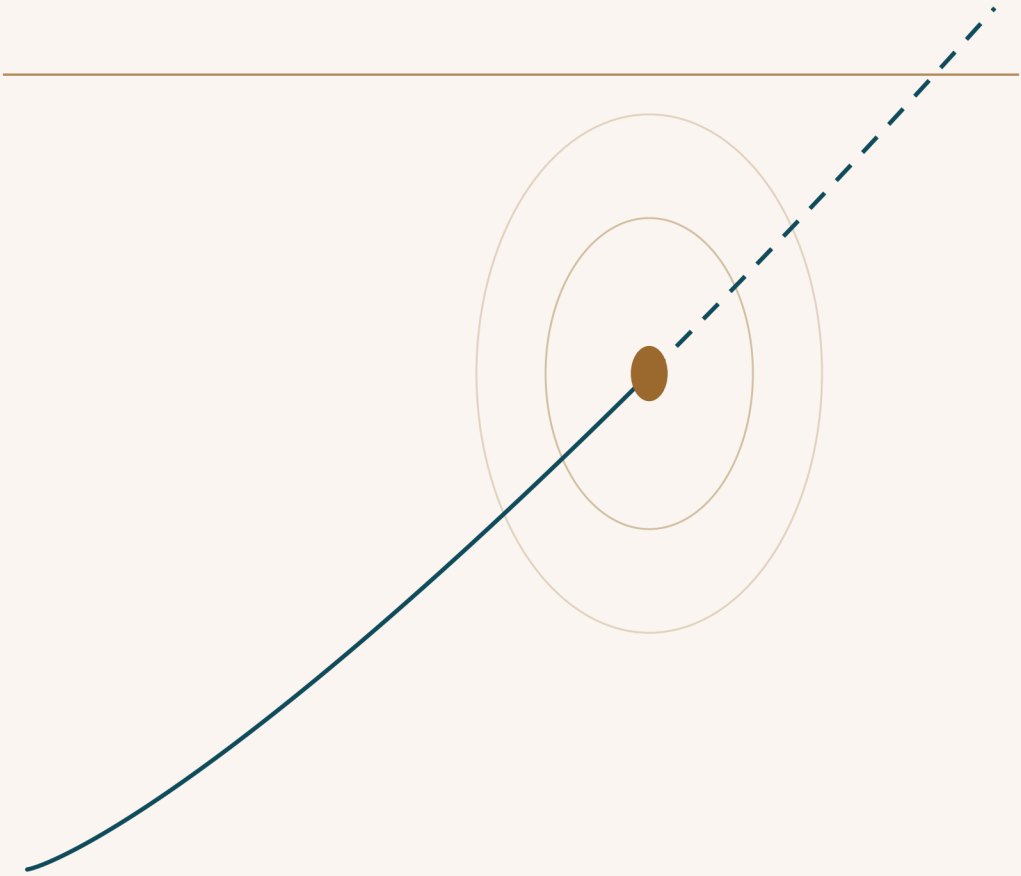
CAC MASTERS SERIES · VOLUME 3

CAC. 702

ADOLESCENT DEVELOPMENT

MASTER IN CHILDREN AND ADOLESCENT COUNSELING



TRIUNE BIBLICAL UNIVERSITY GLOBAL EXTENSION USA

ADOLESCENT DEVELOPMENT

CAC. 702

Adolescent Development

CAC. 702 · First Semester · 1.6 units · A complete lecture course for a sixteen-week semester

TRIUNE BIBLICAL UNIVERSITY GLOBAL EXTENSION USA

First Edition · 2026

Student Handbook of Comprehensive Lectures
Master in Children and Adolescent Counseling

First Edition, 2026

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DEDICATION

To the children and young people who sit in the room and are not yet sure whether they can be helped —

and to the counsellors who learn to be worth trusting.

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About This Book

This volume is the complete lecture course for **CAC. 702 Adolescent Development**, a First Semester core course of the Master in Children and Adolescent Counseling, carrying 1.6 units. It is written to be taught from and studied from without any other material in the room.

What the course is for

Every other course in the programme will teach you something to do with a child or an adolescent. This one teaches you why doing it might work, and how you would know whether it did. A counselling theory is not a belief system and not a loyalty; it is a set of answers to four hard questions — what a child is, what maintains the difficulty, by what mechanism change occurs, and what the counsellor therefore does. Answered well, those questions make practice deliberate, teachable and defensible to the parent, the school, the court or the licensing board that asks what you did and why. Answered badly or not at all, practice becomes a series of intuitive moves that cannot be evaluated and cannot be revised when they fail.

The course moves through the four great lineages of counselling theory — psychodynamic and attachment, behavioural and cognitive, humanistic and existential, systemic and family — reading each against the same four questions, and ends where practice actually lives: in the integration of competing accounts into a formulation for one particular child, held to the standard of the available evidence.

How the semester is organised

Sixteen weeks. Weeks 1 to 14 teach. Week 15 integrates: a comparative practicum in which the whole course is applied to a single extended case. Week 16 consolidates for examination. Each week is one lecture unit of about four notional hours — roughly ninety minutes of scheduled teaching, ninety minutes of seminar or practical work, and the remainder your own reading and writing. Each week has the same shape, and the shape is deliberate: outcomes you can be examined on;

the place of the week in the argument; four key concepts each tied to something a counsellor does in a room; three lectures built from propositions rather than narrative; at least one diagram placed where the argument needs one; worked examples; a practical with a debrief; seminar questions; the assessed task and its criteria; the reading, with the core text marked; and one sentence of synthesis.

A note on the child

The material is addressed throughout to work with children and adolescents, and that is not a decoration on an adult curriculum. A child cannot free-associate, may lack the vocabulary for a cognitive dispute, does not choose to attend, and is embedded in a family and a school that are themselves part of the problem and part of the solution. Theories built for adults fail in particular, predictable ways in a room with a nine-year-old. One purpose of this course is to teach you to see the failure coming.

Standards observed in this volume

British spelling in the book's own prose; American spelling preserved in quoted titles, journal names and direct quotations. Citations in APA 7th edition; only works actually cited are listed; no quotation, statistic or page number has been invented. All case material is fictitious and labelled as such; photographs generated for teaching are captioned as such; standardised instruments are described and attributed but never reproduced. Diagrams are drawn for this edition. The file is a tagged PDF conforming to PDF/UA-1. The governing specification is *HANDBOOK-STANDARD.md*, held with the series.

How to Use This Book

Read the outcomes first and last. Each week opens with what you will be able to do on completing it, written as capabilities that can be observed and examined. Read them before the week and again after it. If you cannot do what they say, you have not finished the week, however much of it you have read.

Work the examples as you meet them. Worked examples are set apart and are not optional reading. Cover the solution, attempt it, then compare. The distance between your attempt and the printed one is precisely the material the examination tests.

Do the practicals. Every week carries a practical — a timed exercise, a formulation task, a role-play, an observation or an analysis of supplied material — with a debrief. Most of them require another person or a recording of yourself and a clock. The practical is the part of the week most often skipped and the part that most changes practice. A theory you have only read is a theory you cannot use.

Keep the comparison grid. Figure 1.3 in week 1 is a blank grid: five questions down the side, four approaches across the top. Complete one column each time the course meets an approach, in your own words, and by week 15 reproduce the whole grid from memory and defend every cell. The grid is the course. Everything else is commentary on it.

Argue with the lectures. Each lecture ends in a clinical implication and a seminar question. The seminar questions are not rhetorical; write answers to them. Where a lecture states a contested position, the contest is named, and your task is to hold a position and say what would change it.

For the tutor. Each week is one four-hour block: ninety minutes of teaching, ninety minutes of seminar or practical work, the remainder preparation and follow-up. The three lectures are self-contained and may be reordered where a cohort needs the case before the theory. The assessed task printed in each week is the task set, and the criteria printed with it are the criteria used. Substitute local material in the vignette and the practical where a cohort's placements differ, provided the substitute is fictitious and labelled.

For the supervisor. The formulation exercises are yours. The question that converts knowledge into judgement is always the same: *which of the approaches in this week would formulate this case differently, and what would that formulation lead you to do on Tuesday?* A trainee who can state a mechanism of change and then say what would falsify it is ready for supervised caseload. A trainee who can only describe a theory is not.

Conventions

Convention	Meaning
Week *n*	the *n*th lecture week of the sixteen-week course
Lecture I, II, III	the three teaching sequences within a week
Worked example	a fully solved illustration; attempt it before reading the solution
Practical	a timed exercise with a debrief; requires a partner, a recording or supplied material
Hypothetical / fictitious composite	case material invented for teaching; no real client is described
Illustrative image (AI-generated)	a photograph created for this edition; depicts no identifiable person
Jurisdiction-dependent	a legal or reporting duty that must be checked against local law

Figures are numbered by week: Figure 3.2 is the second figure of week 3. Figure captions appear below the figure and table captions above the table. Every figure carries alternative text, and the file is tagged for screen readers.

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The Semester at a Glance

Sixteen weeks, one lecture unit each. Weeks 1–14 teach the course; week 15 integrates it on a single extended case; week 16 prepares the examination. The right-hand column names the assessed work of each week; the criteria for each are printed inside the week.

Week	Title	Principal lineage or task	Assessed
1	What Is Adolescence?	definitions, histories, the four questions	Reading response, 600 words
2	Puberty I: Bodies and Timing	the axis, the stages, the clocks	Timing analysis of a case
3	Puberty II: The Adolescent Brain	dual systems, pruning, the perfect storm of sleep	Dual-systems critique, 800 words
4	Thinking in Adolescence	formal operations, egocentrism, hot and cold cognition	Decision case analysis
5	Identity	Erikson, Marcia, ethnic and religious identity	Identity-status interview
6	Self, Esteem and the Body	trajectories, the comparison machine	Self-concept map
7	Emotion and Internalising	the gender gap, self-harm, the conversations that save	Risk-conversation log
8	The Family Renegotiated	autonomy, conflict, monitoring versus snooping	Conflict transcript analysis
9	Peers, Romance, Sexual Development	cliques, co-rumination, peer influence	Peer-ethnography note
10	School, Work and Aspiration	engagement, dropout, career development	Aspirations interview

Week	Title	Principal lineage or task	Assessed
11	Risk, Resilience, Positive Youth Development	function of risk-taking, the five Cs	Five-Cs audit
12	Adolescence Across Cultures	rites, child marriage, WEIRD critique	Critical review, 1,200 words
13	Clinical Adolescence	onsets, formulation, self-harm assessment	Formulation portfolio
14	Practice with Adolescents	engagement, confidentiality, motivational interviewing	Recorded interviewing segment
15	The Practicum: Three Adolescents	case conference at 13, 15 and 17	Practicum presentation
16	Revision and Examination	consolidation, past questions, examination technique	Final examination

Notional hours. 1.6 units ≈ 24 notional learning hours across the sixteen weeks, of which roughly one third is scheduled teaching and two thirds your own preparation, observation and writing. Weeks vary: the practicum week is heavier in supervised work, the revision week lighter in teaching.

Reading load. Each week marks one core text among its six readings. Read the core text before the week's teaching and the remainder across the week. The core texts of the course are Steinberg's *Age of Opportunity*, the *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing (Patton and colleagues), and Sawyer and colleagues on the age of adolescence.

Adolescent Development

SEMESTER	UNITS	CATEGORY
First	1.6	Core

Every counsellor of adolescents carries a theory of adolescence, whether or not it has been examined. It is in the sigh behind "it is just a phase", in the flinch at the two-a-morning phone, in the sentence "we never did this at their age". This course puts those theories on the table, names them, tests them against evidence, and hands you back a set of instruments for understanding an adolescent developing — and for noticing, early and accurately, when development has left its ordinary course.

Adolescence is the strangest interval of the life course: the body matures earlier than it ever has, the social passage to adulthood later than it ever has, and the gap between the two keeps widening. In that gap a brain remakes itself — pruning, myelinating, reweighting reward against control — while the adolescent negotiates identity, esteem, desire, family jurisdiction, peer belonging, aspiration and risk, all at once, in public, with an instrument still under construction. The science of the last thirty years has overturned most of the folklore about this interval: storm and stress is neither universal nor inevitable, teenagers are neither recklessness personified nor adults-in-miniature, and the screens they carry are neither the apocalypse nor nothing. This course teaches what survived the overturning, and what the overturning itself teaches about evidence.

Two commitments govern the volume. The first is to evidence and to its limits: where a finding comes from narrow, wealthy, Western samples, you will be told; where a classic claim has been revised, you will meet the revision; where the honest answer is "we do not know", the book will say so rather than decorate. The second is to context: the adolescents of this programme grow up in compounds and classrooms, markets and churches, in several languages, in economies that tax their parents' patience, and in a digital village that arrives before the electricity sometimes does. An adolescence science that cannot speak to that world is not the science this course teaches.

A fictitious household — Adaeze, fourteen, and her cousin Kelvin, sixteen, in the care of their Auntie Bisi — accompanies the course from week 1 to week 15,

so that each theory meets the same adolescents and you can watch the theories disagree about them. Their story is a labelled composite: no real client is in these pages, and none of it is a case report.

1 LECTURE UNIT 1 Teaching week 1 4 notional hours

What Is Adolescence? Definitions, Histories and the Four Questions

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Define** adolescence biologically, socially and legally, and state why the three definitions disagree about where it begins and ends.
2. **Trace** the invention of adolescence as a concept — Hall's storm and stress, Mead's Samoan counter-evidence, the modern consensus — and say what each episode teaches about evidence.
3. **Explain** the widening-gap account of adolescence's lengthening: earlier puberty, later social adulthood, and the consequences of a longer gap.
4. **Apply** the four questions of the series — what develops, by what process, with what universality, to what purpose — to one adolescent case.
5. **State** the three corrections the modern science makes to "storm and stress": turbulence is not universal, not uniform and not inevitable.

Where this week sits

Volume 2 ended at the school gate of childhood. This volume follows the child through the gate that opens into adolescence — the period your clients will occupy for a decade of their lives and most of your working week. The week begins where all science begins: with the argument about what the thing is. Adolescence is at once a biological event, a social invention and a legal fiction, and the three do not agree; the counsellor works in the space between them.

Key concepts

ADOLESCENCE

The period between the onset of puberty and the assumption of adult roles and responsibilities: bounded at one end by biology and at the other by society, which is why its length is a historical variable rather than a natural kind. In the room: the reason a fourteen-year-old can be a defendant, a mother, a breadwinner and a child in the same week, in the same town.

STORM AND STRESS
Hall's claim that turbulence is inherent to adolescence: conflict with parents, mood disruption, risk behaviour. Partly true at group level, wholly false as destiny: most adolescents pass through with strong family ties and no serious trouble, and where turbulence concentrates it tracks context, not calendar. In the room: the myth that lets services call suffering "a phase".

THE WIDENING GAP
Adolescence lengthens from both ends: pubertal onset earlier (nutrition, health, secular trend) and adult markers later (schooling, labour markets, marriage age). A longer gap means more years of capacity without jurisdiction — more learning, more risk, more of your caseload. In the room: why "in my day we were adults at sixteen" is both true and irrelevant.

EMERGING ADULTHOOD
Arnett's proposal of a distinct period from the late teens through the twenties — identity exploration, instability, self-focus — in societies where adult roles delay further. In the room: the twenty-three-year-old on your caseload who is neither adolescent nor settled adult, and whose formulation needs a name for where they are.

Lecture I — Three definitions, one person

Proposition 1. The biological definition begins with puberty and ends nowhere in particular. Puberty is an event cascade with measurable onsets (week 2); biology offers no equally clean offset, because bodies do not become adult at a moment — they become adult in systems, at different rates, and the brain's reorganisation runs into the mid-twenties.

Proposition 2. The social definition begins and ends with roles, and roles are local. Where marriage, farming or trade admit a person at thirteen, adolescence is short; where a profession and a mortgage admit at twenty-eight, it is long. The social definition is therefore the honest one for practice: an adolescent is a person whom their society treats as not-yet-adult, and the treatment varies by gender, class and locality within a single city.

Proposition 3. The legal definition is a set of lines drawn for administrative reasons, and they contradict each other. The age of criminal responsibility, of consent, of marriage, of voting, of enlistment, of drinking: rarely the same number, sometimes in the same statute book. The counsellor works inside these contradictions daily — a fifteen-year-old who can consent to treatment in one framework and cannot consent to leave school in another — and the file must record which line governed which decision.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Open every adolescent file with three lines: biological stage (pubertal status, in the young), social roles carried (work, care, marriage, school), and the legal lines that touch this month's decisions. Three lines that prevent most of the category errors adolescence invites.

Lecture II — The invention of adolescence, and its refutation, and the consensus

Hall named adolescence in 1904 and gave it a temperament: storm and stress, inevitable turbulence of a transitional age. Mead answered in 1928 from Samoa: where the culture distributed child-rearing widely and sexuality without hysteria, the storm did not appear — adolescence, she argued, is a culture's product more than a gland's. The modern reading of that famous dispute is a lesson in evidence: Mead's fieldwork was thinner than her prose, and Hall's universal was a description of his own society's adolescents; both overreached, and the truth that survived is the transaction — puberty supplies the reorganisation, culture supplies the weather.

The consensus that followed, and that governs this volume, has three corrections to storm and stress. **Turbulence is not universal:** most adolescents report good family relationships, no serious risk behaviour, and no disorder; the minority in whom turbulence concentrates is identifiable by context — conflict at home, deviancy-prone peers, unsupervised time, early puberty in a late-maturing school. **Turbulence is not uniform:** it peaks in early to mid-adolescence for conflict and risk, and later for some internalising difficulty; a sixteen-year-old's calm is not evidence that the fourteen-year-old's storm was imaginary. **Turbulence is not inevitable:** it is the product of identifiable transactions, and transactions can be changed — which is the entire warrant for this profession's work with adolescents.

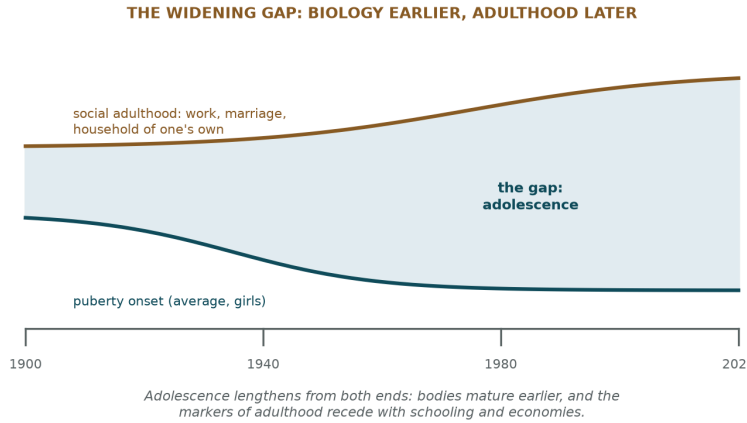


Figure 1.1 The widening gap across 1900-2020: pubertal onset falling, social adulthood rising, and the shaded space between them — adolescence — lengthening from both ends. *Source:* prepared for this edition, after Sawyer et al. (2018) and Patton et al. (2016).

Lecture III — The four questions, adolescent form

What develops? The body through puberty; the brain through pruning, myelination and a reorganisation of reward and control systems (week 3); cognition into hypothesis and abstraction (week 4); the self into an identity with commitments (weeks 5–6); emotion regulation into an adult repertoire under new emotional weather (week 7); relationships into autonomy-with-attachment at home and intimacy in friendship and romance (weeks 8–9).

By what process? Hormonal cascade and brain reorganisation; the social redefinition that hands the adolescent new audiences and new mirrors; and, above all, transaction — the adolescent's new behaviours evoking new responses from parents, peers and institutions, which shape the next round of behaviour. Adolescence is the clearest demonstration in the whole curriculum that development is a two-way street: the child who becomes an adolescent changes the household, and the changed household changes the adolescent.

With what universality? Puberty's sequence is universal; its timing is not. Identity work appears wherever society grants a moratorium; where it grants none, identity is foreclosed early and the "crisis" your textbooks describe is a luxury of the gap. The WEIRD critique of volume 1 bites hardest here: much adolescent psychology was built on American high-school students, and the adolescent of this programme may be a trader, a carer, a spouse or a migrant worker at fourteen.

To what purpose? To produce, by the end of the period, a person who can regulate emotion, hold commitments, work with others and tolerate uncertainty

— and to produce them by rehearsal, in the safest theatre available. Adolescence is not a storm to survive; it is a specialisation period for becoming someone, and the counsellor's work is to keep the theatre safe enough to rehearse in.

The running case of this volume

Adaeze and Kelvin — a fictitious composite. Adaeze ("Ada") is fourteen, in Secondary 2: bright, recently quiet, her mother says "the light has gone out of her" since the move to the senior school; she sleeps late, wakes late, and has stopped singing in the church choir. Her cousin Kelvin is sixteen, in SS1, repeating: charming, unreliable, recently arrested for a phone snatch he says he "only held", and the family's declared problem. Their auntie Bisi runs the household — the children's mother trades in another state, their father died when Ada was nine. No real family is described; the details accumulate week by week as each theory meets them.

Worked example 1.1 — Three definitions on one file

Task. Kelvin, sixteen, is charged as an adult-equivalent under one statute, treated as a child under the children's statute for care purposes, married in no law but expected in his community to contribute as a man, and biologically post-pubertal since thirteen. Write the three definition lines and state which governs your work this month.

Solution. Biological: post-pubertal three years; brain reorganisation mid-course; sleep phase delayed (week 3). Social: expected to earn and to be a man; granted no moratorium; his "irresponsibility" is judged against an adult role he carries economically but not juridically. Legal: criminal responsibility as charged; care and protection as a child; no voting, no contract. The governing definition for counselling this month: the social one, because the maintaining transactions run through the role-gap — he is treated as a man when he earns and as a boy when he decides, and the inconsistency is precisely what his risk behaviour negotiates. The file records all three lines and names the governor, so that when the court letter arrives the formulation does not have to be reinvented under pressure.

Worked example 1.2 — Storm and stress, audited

Task. Auntie Bisi says of Kelvin: "boys this age are madness itself; it will pass." Audit the claim against the three corrections.

Solution. Not universal: Kelvin's co-rumination-free cousin Ada is turbulent in a different register (withdrawal, sleep), and most of their peers are neither arrested nor withdrawn — the claim generalises from the loudest case. Not uniform: Kelvin's conflict and risk peaked at fifteen to sixteen, consistent with the group curve; Ada's internalising presentation is on a later-rising curve, so "it will pass" applied to her would be a missed depression (week 7). Not inevitable: the transactions maintaining Kelvin's risk are nameable — unsupervised evenings, a

deviancy-prone peer set, a household whose monitoring collapsed into snooping then into surrender (week 8) — each changeable, and the change is the work. The counsel to Bisi honours her sentence and corrects its grammar: "You are right that much of this is the age. You are also right that it passes — for most boys, because most boys have what Kelvin lost: an adult who knows where they are at nine o'clock. We are going to put that back, and then we will see what the age is doing and what it was never doing."

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 1 — the three-line opening. Take two adolescent cases you know (anonymised) or the supplied pair. Write the three definition lines (biological, social, legal) for each, then one sentence naming which definition governs your work this month and why. Exchange with a partner and defend the governor sentence against one objection. 300 words total; the mark is for the governor sentence.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A reading response of 600 words: choose one claim in this week's core text about what is universal in adolescence, state its sample, and argue whether it travels to the adolescents you will counsel — ending with one practice change the argument compels.

Criterion	Weight
Claim stated precisely with its sample	30%
Universality argued, not asserted	40%
Practice change concrete	30%

Formative. Submit the three-line opening for both cases.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Adolescence is bounded by biology at one end and by society at the other, which is why its length is history's variable; storm and stress survives only as three corrections — not universal, not uniform, not inevitable; and the period is best understood as a specialisation for becoming someone, rehearsed in the safest theatre available, which is what the counsellor is employed to keep safe.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Arnett, J. J. (2000). Emerging adulthood: A theory of development from the late teens through the twenties. *American Psychologist, 55*(5), 469–480.
- Hall, G. S. (1904). *Adolescence: Its psychology and its relations to physiology, anthropology, sociology, sex, crime, religion and education*. D. Appleton.

- Mead, M. (1928). *Coming of age in Samoa: A psychological study of primitive youth for Western civilisation*. William Morrow.
- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., … Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478. — **core text**.
- Sawyer, S. M., Azzopardi, P. S., Wickremarathne, D., & Patton, G. C. (2018). The age of adolescence. *The Lancet Child & Adolescent Health, 2*(3), 223–228. — **core text**.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; chapter 1.

Seminar questions

1. Which of the three definitions governs your own society's treatment of a married fourteen-year-old, and which should?
2. Mead versus Hall: what does the dispute teach about the sample behind every universal?
3. "It will pass." Under which of the three corrections does the sentence become dangerous, and for whom?
4. If adolescence lengthens because adulthood recedes, what does a twenty-three-year-old client owe the adolescent framework?
5. What was your own adolescence's theatre, and who kept it safe?

Next week

Week 2 follows the body: the axis that wakes, the stages it drives, the clocks of timing, and the psychological consequences of maturing early or late in a particular school.

2 LECTURE UNIT 2 Teaching week 2 4 notional hours

Puberty I: Bodies, Timing and Their Consequences

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Outline** the hypothalamic–pituitary–gonadal axis and its feedback, and state why puberty's first changes are invisible and nocturnal.
2. **Describe** the sequence of pubertal changes in girls and boys, and use stage language carefully in files and with families.

3. **Explain** the secular trend in pubertal timing and its principal drivers, without overclaiming any single cause.
4. **Analyse** the psychological consequences of early and late maturation in each sex, in context: the same timing, different meanings in different schools and peer groups.
5. **Counsel** a family through an off-timing puberty — early, late, or discordant with gender identity — with accuracy and without shame.

Where this week sits

Adolescence begins in the body, and the body's timetable is the first thing a counsellor must know because it sets the stage for everything else: the child whose body races ahead of the peer group meets a different social world from the child whose body lags, and neither world is the one the child's age would suggest. This week is endocrinology for counsellors: enough mechanism to be accurate, enough context to be humane, and the timing literature that turns "early" and "late" from adjectives into formulations.

Key concepts

HPG AXIS
Hypothalamus, pituitary, gonads (with the adrenals contributing the first androgens): a feedback system whose pulse pattern changes in sleep years before anything is visible, so that puberty is under way long before anyone can see it — and long before the child can name what is happening. In the room: the reason a nine-year-old's mood can be pubertal before any adult would use the word.

SECULAR TREND
The century-scale fall in pubertal onset, steepest in the early twentieth century with nutrition and infection control, continuing more slowly since; drivers debated across nutrition, body fat, stress and endocrine-disrupting exposures, with no single cause established. In the room: the reason "she is too young for this" is often false, and the reason the gap of week 1 keeps widening at its early end.

OFF-TIMING
Maturing markedly earlier or later than one's peer group; the consequences run through the social meaning of the difference — early-maturing girls face sexualised attention they did not seek, early-maturing boys gain status that recruits them upward in age among peers, late-maturing boys lose size in a size-valuing peer culture, late-maturing girls are largely spared the early girl's sexualisation and largely silent about the relief. In the room: timing effects are context effects, and the context is where the work is.

PUBERTY AND GENDER

For a child whose gender identity does not match the body puberty is building, pubertal changes are not development but injury; the clinical conversation includes the existence of pause-and-pathways care where law and service permit, and always includes the child's own words first. In the room: the week's hardest counselling, and the week's clearest duty to accuracy without shame.

Lecture I — The axis that wakes

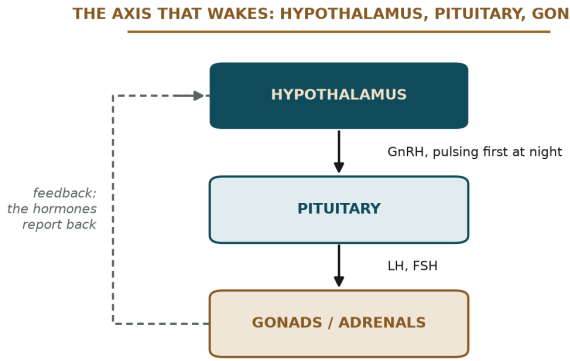


Figure 2.1 The hypothalamic-pituitary-gonadal axis with its feedback loop: GnRH pulsing first at night, gonadotrophins, gonadal and adrenal hormones, and the hormones reporting back to the brain. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

Proposition 1. Puberty is a change in a conversation, not the arrival of a substance. The hormones were always present; what changes is the hypothalamus's pulse pattern, released from childhood inhibition, first at night — which is why growth hormone and the early gonadotrophin pulses arrive in sleep, and why the first pubertal evidence a family sees is often a change in sleep and growth rather than in shape.

Proposition 2. The sequence is orderly; the timing is not. Breast development or testicular enlargement first, then pubic hair, then the growth spurt, then menarche or voice-change late in the sequence — the order holds, the ages scatter across several years, and menarche arrives after the peak of the height spurt, which is why the tall girl in SS1 may still be years from cycles and the short one may not. Files that record "puberty complete" on shape alone are files that will misdate everything downstream.

Proposition 3. The adrenals start their own clock. Adrenarche — the adrenal androgen rise with its body odour, skin and hair changes — runs on a separate schedule from the gonadal axis, and it is usually the first thing the household notices; the child who "smells like a person now" at eight is not precocious on the gonadal clock, and the reassurance is worth a sentence in the consultation.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** Date puberty in the file by stage and informant, not by impression: what has been observed, by whom, since when — and where the child is a transgender or gender-questioning child, record that the staging conversation follows the child's lead and the safeguarding and medical pathways of week 13.

Lecture II — Timing and its meanings

The secular trend is real and uneven: onset fell dramatically as nutrition and infection control improved, and continues to fall more slowly, with obesity, early-life stress and some chemical exposures each carrying partial evidence and none carrying the whole effect. The honest sentence to a family: "bodies start earlier than they used to, for reasons science has not finished arguing about; your daughter is not abnormal, and she is not behind — she is on today's curve."

The off-timing literature is the counsellor's part. **Early-maturing girls** face attention from older peers and adults that sexualises a child; their elevated rates of internalising difficulty and of early substance use track that attention and the peer company it recruits, not the hormones alone — which is why the intervention is the environment's conduct, never the girl's clothing. **Early-maturing boys** gain stature and status, are recruited upward in age by peers and by coaches, and carry risks that look like privilege: older company, older substances, older offences. **Late-maturing boys** lose the size economy of the peer group and show elevated teasing and, in some samples, later-recovering self-esteem. **Late-maturing girls** report the least distress of the four groups, and the finding is a window into what early maturation actually costs: the relief of the late girl is the measure of the early girl's burden.

All four patterns are context-dependent: a school that groups by age and prizes size amplifies; a school that groups by skill and prizes work dampens; a household with an adult who notices and names protects. Timing sets the stage; the cast decides the play.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Two safeguarding edges attach to pubertal timing. First, the sexualised attention to an early-maturing child is adult and peer conduct, and where it crosses into harassment or abuse the child is a victim and the record must say so in those words

— no formulation of "early maturity" may drift into implying invitation. Second, where a family seeks to "protect" an early-maturing daughter by withdrawing her from school or hastening marriage, the child's right to education and to childhood governs, and the counsellor's duty is to the child with the family in the room, not to the family's fear.

Lecture III — Counselling the off-timing body

The early girl. Accuracy first: what is happening, in what order, over what months, so the body stops being a rumour. Conduct second: the family's and school's obligations named plainly — no adult comments on her body, no older-peer contact unsupervised, the uniform and sport questions solved with her rather than for her. Meaning third: the sentence that protects the self — "your body is early; your childhood is not over; nothing about this makes you older than you are" — repeated by every adult in the house, because she will hear the opposite daily.

The late boy. The work is smaller and real: the peer economy of size named as an economy rather than a verdict; one competence domain where he is visibly good and publicly so; and the forecast, honestly given, that the size gap closes and usually reverses — with the dates of his own father's or uncle's late growth if the family knows them, because a family story outperforms a statistic.

The child whose gender and body disagree. The conversation begins with the child's words and ends nowhere in a single session. Three duties: accuracy about what puberty will do if it proceeds, because the child deserves the map; accuracy about what care exists — pause-and-pathways where law and service permit, and the referral route with its waiting times, because false hope is a harm; and the immediate work that needs no pathway at all — the social affirmation the family can give now, the school's conduct, and the child's own naming of themselves, which is protective in the evidence and costs nothing but courage.

> **PRACTICE NOTE**
> **Clinical implication.** Rehearse the puberty conversation in your counselling language until it is plain: axis, sequence, timing, meaning, conduct. Families do not forget the consultation in which a professional named the body without shame; they forget everything else about that month.

Worked example 2.1 — Ada at nine-and-a-half

Task. Ada's development began at nine-and-a-half: breast development and odour, then pubic hair; menarche at eleven-and-a-half, in a school where most girls began at twelve-and-a-half or later. She is now fourteen and says she "hates being looked at". Formulate the timing strand.

Solution. On-timing by population norms, off-timing by peer group: the distinction that organises everything. Between nine-and-a-half and twelve she was the earliest body in her class for two and a half years — the precise window in which the early-maturing girl's risks concentrate: sexualised comment (an uncle's joke, recalled verbatim in session three), older-boy attention at the gate, and the choir's withdrawal when her voice and shape changed before her friends'. The maintaining transactions now: she dresses to disappear, which reads as sullenness and recruits correction; she sleeps late, which the household reads as laziness and recruits conflict; both are protections she cannot name without naming the looking. The formulation's timing strand therefore reads: early-relative-to-peers maturation with sexualised attention history; current maintenance by concealment strategies misread as conduct problems; intervention aimed at the conduct of the environment (a school conversation about gate conduct, with Ada's consent and without her exposure), the household's reading of her strategies (week 8′s reframing), and one domain where her body is an instrument rather than an object — she chooses it, and the choir, if it returns, must return on her terms. Falsifier, dated: if the "hated looking" sentence broadens into global self-worth collapse or eating restriction (week 6, week 13), the timing strand is not the governing strand and the formulation reorders.

Worked example 2.2 — Kelvin's late cousin, and the family story

Task. Chuka (Kelvin's friend, fifteen) is the smallest boy in SS1, teased as "pikin", and has begun refusing sport. Counsel in the register of this week.

Solution. Three moves. The economy named: "In your school, size is money in the boys' market. That is a fact about the market, not about you." The competence domain: he is the best goalkeeper the junior team had two years ago and left when the size teasing began; the return is engineered not by persuasion but by a role the team needs now — penalty practice specialist, a public competence that does not require winning a tackle. The forecast with a family story: his uncle, present at the conversation, tells his own fifteen-year-small, twenty-year-tall history in ninety seconds, with the dates; the boy's face changes at the dates, not at the adjectives. The record notes the peer-economy sentence, the role, the story, and the review date at term's end with one observable: whether he stays after practice twice. The safeguarding note: teasing that becomes organised humiliation is bullying with a power asymmetry, and the school's duty is engaged the week it is named — this week.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 2 — the timing audit. For one adolescent case (supplied or your own, anonymised): date pubertal onset and current stage with informant; locate the child

against their peer group's timing, not the population's; list the social meanings their timing has carried in their school and household; and write one environmental intervention and one meaning intervention. 400 words. The mark is for the peer-group comparison, which most audits omit.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A timing analysis of 900 words on a supplied case: stage and informant, population versus peer-group timing, the social meanings carried, the maintaining transactions, and two interventions (environment, meaning) each with a dated falsifier.

Criterion	Weight
Stage dated with informant; population v. peer group distinguished	30%
Social meanings specified, not assumed	25%
Transactions maintaining the current difficulty	25%
Interventions concrete, dated, falsifiable	20%

Formative. Write the puberty conversation's first three sentences in your counselling language, plain enough for a frightened eleven-year-old.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Puberty is a change in a feedback conversation that begins in sleep; its sequence is orderly and its timing is not; the secular trend lengthens adolescence at its early end; and off-timing consequences run through social meaning — the attention, the status, the teasing — so the counsellor dates the body accurately, locates it against the peer group rather than the population, aims at the environment's conduct and the child's meaning, and holds the gender-discordant child's map and hope with equal accuracy.

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- Berk, L. E. (2013). *Child development* (9th ed.). Pearson. — the puberty chapter, for sequence and staging.
- Blakemore, S.-J., Burnett, S., & Dahl, R. E. (2010). The role of puberty in the developing adolescent brain. *Human Brain Mapping, 31*(6), 926–933.
- Dahl, R. E. (2004). Adolescent brain development: A period of vulnerabilities and opportunities. *Annals of the New York Academy of Sciences, 1021*(1), 1–22.
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Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., ... Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478.

- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; chapter 2.

Seminar questions

1. Why does the first pubertal evidence arrive in sleep, and what does that teach about what families notice first?
2. An early-maturing girl's risk runs through other people's conduct. What follows for where the intervention sits?
3. Late-maturing girls report the least distress. What exactly does that finding measure?
4. Where your law and service permit pause-and-pathways care, what does the child deserve to know, and when?
5. Which adult named your own body without shame at puberty — and what did they say?

Next week

Week 3 follows the hormones into the skull: pruning, myelination, the dual systems of reward and control, and the sleep storm that makes the first bell of the morning an act of institutional jet lag.

3 LECTURE UNIT 3 Teaching week 3 4 notional hours

Puberty II: The Adolescent Brain and the Perfect Storm of Sleep

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Describe** adolescent brain development in its three movements: synaptic pruning, myelination, and the differential maturation of reward and control systems.
2. **State** the dual-systems account and its critics, and use the model as a hypothesis about vulnerability windows rather than as an excuse.
3. **Explain** the adolescent sleep phase delay as biological, and compute the mismatch between biological sleep and school bells for a given timetable.
4. **Critique** brain-based overclaiming in popular discourse: what the neuroscience does and does not license a counsellor to say.

5. **Advise** a school or family on three sleep-protective changes with evidence behind each.

Where this week sits

The hormones of week 2 reach a brain that is mid-renovation. This week is the neuroscience a counsellor actually needs: not to excuse anyone, but to locate the vulnerability windows, to explain to a parent why the same child reasons like an adult at nine in the morning and like a stranger at eleven at night, and to make the case — in evidence, not in sentiment — for the later school bell.

Key concepts

PRUNING AND MYELINATION

Two simultaneous movements: the elimination of unused synapses (use it or lose it, on an adolescent schedule) and the insulation of the connections that remain, which speeds and coordinates them. The adolescent brain is therefore not an unfinished adult brain but a specialised one: highly plastic, rapidly specialising to whatever the adolescent actually does. In the room: the scientific warrant for filling the years with practice rather than with waiting.

DUAL SYSTEMS

Reward-sensitivity rises steeply with puberty and peaks in mid-adolescence; cognitive control rises more slowly into the mid-twenties; the gap between the curves is the window of elevated risk-taking — and of elevated learning, because the same reward sensitivity that funds the dare funds the mastery. In the room: a hypothesis about windows, never a verdict about character.

SLEEP PHASE DELAY

At puberty the circadian clock shifts later: melatonin onset moves towards the night, and the adolescent body wants to sleep around eleven and wake around eight. Early school bells therefore impose chronic partial sleep deprivation on the youngest adolescents, with costs in mood, attention, memory consolidation and road risk on the morning commute. In the room: the most evidence-backed, least expensive intervention in adolescent mental health, and the hardest to win.

HOT-COLD GAP

Adolescent decision-making approximates adult performance in cold cognition (alone, unhurried, unaroused) and diverges sharply in hot cognition (peers present, emotion high, time short). In the room: why the same adolescent who analyses a

dilemma wisely in your office makes the disastrous choice at the party, and why the intervention is the situation rather than the lecture.

Lecture I — Three movements of renovation

Proposition 1. Pruning is specialisation, and specialisation is political. The synapses that survive adolescence are the ones the adolescent uses; the ones that do not, go. A decade spent in fear prunes a fear-specialised brain; a decade spent in music, sport, argument or care prunes accordingly. The counsellor's interest is therefore not only in what the adolescent suffers but in what the adolescent **does**, because the doing is the sculpting.

Proposition 2. Myelination coordinates, and coordination is what judgement is. Judgement is rarely one region's work; it is the timed coordination of many, and myelination of the long tracts — prefrontal to limbic, across hemispheres — is what makes coordination fast enough to matter in a hot moment. The slow maturation of these tracts is the biological grain inside the hot-cold gap.

Proposition 3. The dual-systems gap is a window with two faces. The same reward sensitivity that elevates risk elevates learning: adolescence is the peak period for skill acquisition, for love of novelty, for the courage to leave the compound and try the stage. A discourse that reads the gap only as danger has misread a specialisation period as a defect, and has missed the intervention: fill the window with mastery, and the window fills with mastery.

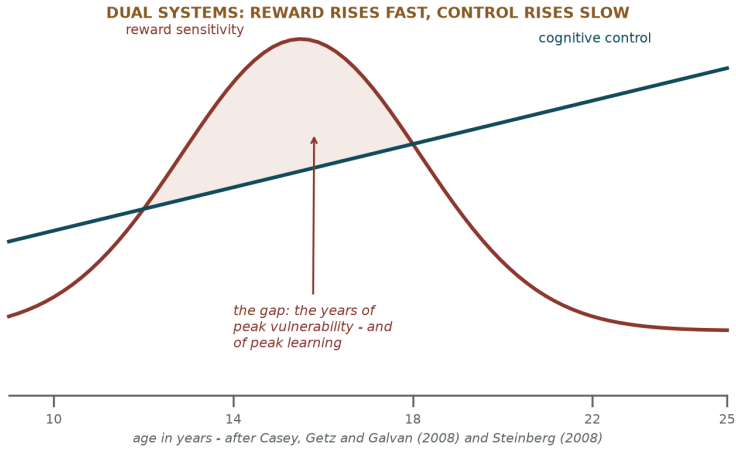


Figure 3.1 Dual systems across ages 9-25: reward sensitivity peaking in mid-adolescence while cognitive control rises slowly; the shaded gap is the window of peak vulnerability and of peak learning. After Casey, Getz and Galvan (2008) and Steinberg (2008). *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Ask the pruning question in every adolescent intake: what does this adolescent actually do, most days, for hours? The answer names the brain being built, and it names the material any intervention has to work with.

Lecture II — The model and its critics

The dual-systems account has been usefully attacked, and the attacks improve it. **Timing critique:** control systems mature earlier in cold laboratory tasks than the model's rhetoric suggests; the gap is smaller in the cold and larger in the hot, which is precisely the hot-cold finding. **Social critique:** the "peer effect" is not mere presence but evaluation — adolescents take more risks when they believe they are being watched by peers whose opinion matters, which relocates the mechanism from arousal to social evaluation, and social evaluation is something a counsellor can work with. **Determinism critique:** the curves are group averages with enormous individual and contextual variance; sleep, stress, substance use and training move an individual's control function materially.

The disciplined use follows: the model licenses **window-talk** (these years carry elevated risk and elevated learning under evaluation and arousal), **situation-talk** (change the heat, the audience and the hour, and the same mind performs differently), and **no excuse-talk** (the brain account explains; it does not exempt; and an adolescent who hears their prefrontal cortex cited as their alibi has been handed a script for helplessness).

SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT

Brain-talk in files and courts carries risk: "his prefrontal cortex is immature" reads, in a hearing, as "not responsible", and in a family, as "cannot help it". Neither reading serves the child. The sentence that serves: "the adolescent brain explains elevated vulnerability under heat and audience; it does not remove capacity to learn from consequences delivered fairly, and it makes the arrangement of situations — not the abolition of expectations — the treatment."

Lecture III — Sleep: the perfect storm, and the bell

At puberty the circadian phase delays: melatonin onset shifts later by roughly one to two hours across the transition, and sleep pressure builds more slowly, so the adolescent body at ten at night is physiologically where the child's body was at eight. Add early bells — seven-thirty in many secondary schools — and the result is chronic partial deprivation: the adolescent sleeps late from biology, wakes early from institution, and repays the debt at weekends with a nine-hour collapse that further delays the clock. The costs are not subtle: mood and irritability, attention and working-memory loss (volume 2, week 5), impaired consolidation of the

day's learning, elevated depressive symptoms in several cohorts, and the morning commute run on a sleep-deprived attention system.

The interventions, in order of evidence and cheapness: **later bells** where any flexibility exists — the single change with the strongest returns in attendance, mood and attainment in the school-start literature; **light and dark hygiene** — morning light outside, screens dimmed and out of the bed, because light is the clock's hand; **homework and chore architecture** — the evening's demands moved earlier or reduced, because a phase-delayed child cannot do algebra at midnight and call it discipline; and **weekend debt limits** — lie-ins capped at about two hours past weekday waking, because larger shifts re-jet-lag the week.

The counsellor's role is advocacy with arithmetic: compute the mismatch for the actual timetable, present it with the costs, and offer the cheapest change first. Where the bell cannot move this year, the evening can, and the family's evening is the counsellor's jurisdiction.

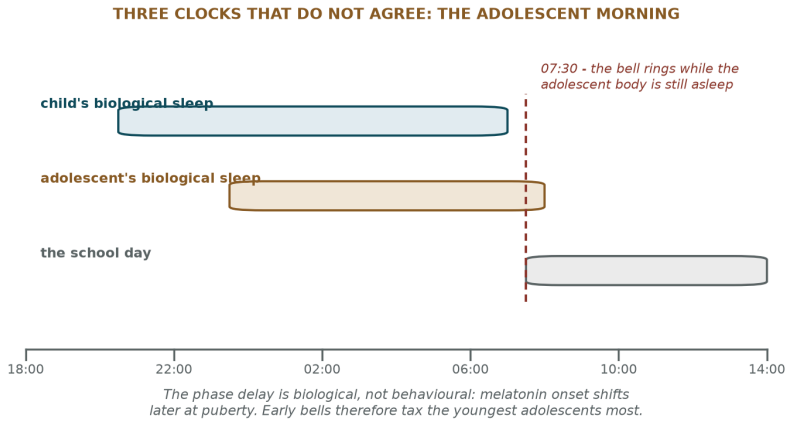


Figure 3.2 Three clocks that do not agree: the child's biological sleep window, the adolescent's delayed window, and the school day beginning at 07:30 while the adolescent body is still asleep; the phase delay is biological, not behavioural. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. In every adolescent intake, one sleep line: bedtime, wake time, bell time, weekend lie-in, screens in bed. Five numbers that explain a surprising share of what the file will otherwise call mood disorder, laziness or defiance.

Worked example 3.1 — Ada's "laziness", computed

Task. Ada sleeps at 23:30 on school nights (body willing), wakes at 06:15 for a 07:30 bell, and sleeps to 11:00 on Saturdays. Compute the mismatch and write the family sentence.

Solution. Weeknight sleep about six hours three-quarters against a biological need nearer nine: a daily debt of about two and a quarter hours, five days a week — eleven hours a week, repaid partly on Saturday with a four-and-a-half-hour lie-in that delays Sunday night's onset and guarantees Monday's worst morning. The household reads the Saturday collapse as laziness and the Monday misery as attitude; both are arithmetic. The family sentence, plain: "Her body's clock moved at puberty, the way bodies do. The bell did not move. Between them she loses eleven hours a week, and every one of them comes out of her mood, her memory and her mornings. We are not going to win against her biology with punishment; we are going to take two hours back from the evening, cap the Saturday lie-in at two hours past her weekday waking, and put the phone outside the room at ten — and in six weeks we will compare the mornings." The school sentence, for the advocacy file: the same arithmetic with the attendance and attainment literature attached, and the cheapest ask first — move the first period's hardest subject later in the morning, which costs nothing and returns the second period.

Worked example 3.2 — The party and the office: hot cognition in one case

Task. Kelvin reasons carefully in session about the phone-snatch episode — consequences, victims, his own fear — and eleven days later is in a fight at a party with his peers watching. Reconcile without excusing.

Solution. The two Kelvins are one mind in two weathers. In the office: cold cognition — alone, unhurried, unwatched, and his reasoning approximates an adult's, which the session record shows. At the party: hot cognition — peers evaluating, alcohol present, provocation in the moment — and the same reasoning function is outperformed by the evaluation-audience mechanism the dual-systems literature names. The reconciliation sentence for the file and for Kelvin: "Your thinking in this room is real and it is yours; at the party, the audience borrowed it. The work is not to grow a new brain but to arrange the situations — who is with you, what is in your hand, when you leave — so the brain you already have gets to the party." Consequences stand: the fight has victims and a school process, and fairness requires they proceed; the formulation changes the **plan**, not the accountability. The falsifier is behavioural and dated: if, with two agreed situation-arrangements in place (a leaving time and a peer pair), the next eight weeks pass without a hot-cognition incident, the situation hypothesis holds;

if incidents recur inside arranged situations, the formulation turns to the peer set's function and to week 9's deviancy questions.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 3 — the sleep audit and the ask. Take one adolescent case or a supplied timetable. Compute the weekly sleep debt from five numbers; list three changes in evidence order (bell or subject-timing, evening architecture, weekend cap, light and screens); and write the two sentences — family version and school version — with which you would ask for the cheapest one. 300 words. The mark is for the arithmetic being visible in both sentences.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A dual-systems critique of 800 words: state the model, one timing critique and one social critique, then argue — with one case — what the model licenses a counsellor to say and what it forbids, ending with the no-excuse sentence in your own words.

Criterion	Weight
Model stated accurately, curves and window	30%
Critiques engaged, not name-dropped	30%
Licensed and forbidden sentences distinguished	25%
No-excuse sentence present and usable	15%

Formative. Submit the sleep audit with both ask-sentences.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The adolescent brain is renovating: pruning specialises to what the adolescent does, myelination coordinates what judgement needs, and reward and control mature on different clocks whose gap is a window of risk and of learning alike; sleep's phase delay makes early bells an institutional jet lag with measurable costs; and the disciplined use of all this is window-talk, situation-talk and no excuse-talk — the brain explains, the situation treats, and the child remains a person accountable inside both.

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Seminar questions

1. Pruning specialises to use. What is your service asking adolescents to specialise in, by what it gives them to do?
2. The peer effect is evaluation, not mere presence. What changes in an intervention once you accept that?
3. Compute your own adolescent sleep debt from memory. Which of the four interventions would have recovered the most hours, cheapest?
4. Where is the line between explaining and excusing, in a sentence you would actually say to a court?
5. A school says bells cannot move. What is your cheapest ask, and what evidence do you carry to the meeting?

Next week

Week 4 turns to thinking: formal operations in practice, adolescent egocentrism's two mirrors — the imaginary audience and the personal fable — and the hot-cold gap as it appears in the decisions that reach your desk.

4 LECTURE UNIT 4 Teaching week 4 4 notional hours

Thinking in Adolescence: Formal Operations, Egocentrism and Decisions Under Heat

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Describe** formal-operational thought in adolescence — hypothesis, abstraction, the ideal against the real — and its uneven arrival across domains and schooling.
2. **Explain** adolescent egocentrism's two constructions: the imaginary audience and the personal fable, and use each to read a clinical sentence.
3. **Distinguish** hot from cold cognition in a decision analysis, and locate the divergence point for one case.

4. **Counsel** with the idealism of formal operations rather than against it: the adolescent's newly discovered ideals as therapeutic material.
5. **Design** one decision-support arrangement that changes the heat rather than the lecture.

Where this week sits

The adolescent mind acquires a new instrument — the ability to think about thought, to hold the hypothetical, to compare what is with what could be — and the instrument has side-effects: an audience that is always watching, a fable of personal exception, and an idealism that finds every adult arrangement wanting. This week is the cognitive adolescence of the series: what changes in thinking, what the changes cost, and how the counsellor recruits the new instrument to the work instead of arguing with its side-effects.

Key concepts

FORMAL OPERATIONS
Thought about the hypothetical and the ideal: reasoning from possibilities rather than only from objects, holding variables in mind and testing them, and — decisively for practice — comparing the real against the possible, which is the root of adolescent critique of parents, schools, religions and selves. In the room: the reason the fifteen-year-old can dismantle your argument and cannot yet weigh it against tomorrow.

IMAGINARY AUDIENCE
The construction that others are as preoccupied with the self as the self is: the audience that notices the shirt, the stumble, the silence. Not vanity but a cognitive over-extension of the new ability to model other minds — modelled, now, relentlessly, upon the self. In the room: the mechanism under the shame spiral, the refused assembly, the deleted photograph.

PERSONAL FABLE
The construction of personal uniqueness and exception: my experience is unlike anyone's, and the ordinary consequences do not apply to me — the fable that funds both the dare and the solitude ("no one has ever felt this"). In the room: the sentence beneath "it won't happen to me" and beneath "no one understands", which are the same sentence in two weathers.

HOT-COLD DIVERGENCE
The gap between decision performance in cold conditions (alone, unhurried, unaroused) and hot conditions (peers, emotion, immediacy); in adolescence the gap

widens sharply, and the divergence point — the moment the decision moved from cold to hot — is usually identifiable in the narrative and is where the intervention sits. In the room: the analytic question "at which sentence did the room get hot?"

Lecture I — The new instrument and its uneven arrival

Proposition 1. Formal operations arrive as a capacity and mature as a practice. The adolescent who can hold a hypothesis in a chemistry argument may reason concretely about their own future in the same hour; the capacity is domain-sensitive and schooling-sensitive, and it is exercised where a culture exercises it — in argument, in examination, in faith instruction, in market negotiation. The counsellor therefore tests the instrument in the domain of the problem, not in the abstract.

Proposition 2. The ideal becomes a tool, and tools are dangerous. With the possible in hand, the adolescent measures the real: the parent against the ideal parent, the school against the ideal school, the self against the ideal self. The critique that follows is not disrespect but development doing its work — and the self-measurement is the strand that, unmoderated, becomes the perfectionism and body-comparison of week 6.

Proposition 3. Metacognition makes the self an object of study. The adolescent can now think about their own thinking, which is the precondition of every reflective therapy — and the precondition of rumination, which is reflection without an exit. The same instrument that powers the therapeutic conversation powers the two-a-morning loop; the difference is structure, and structure is teachable.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Locate the instrument before using it: one hypothesis question in the domain of the problem ("if your belief about the party is true, what would we see on the video?"). If the adolescent can hold it, the therapy can be collaborative; if not, the work is enactment and experience first, and reflection later.

Lecture II — Two mirrors: audience and fable

Elkind's constructions explain a family of clinical sentences. **The imaginary audience** reads: "everyone saw my hands shake"; "I cannot go back to that class"; "the whole church was looking". The audience is a cognitive over-extension — the new mind-modelling turned upon the self — and it is treatable as a hypothesis rather than as a fact: who, exactly, was looking? what did they see? what did they do in the next minute? The deconstruction is Socratic and brief, because the audience rarely survives its own headcount.

The personal fable reads two ways. As exception: "that pregnancy talk is about other girls"; "the bike without lights is fine, I know that road"; the fable here is a hypothesis about base rates that can be tested with the adolescent's own data. As solitude: "no one has ever felt this"; the fable here is a grief about uniqueness, and it is met not by headcount but by witness — the sentence "I hear that it feels unlike anything anyone has felt; I am here, in it, with you" precedes any cognitive work, because a fable of solitude dismantled before it is witnessed becomes proof of itself.

The two mirrors share a root and a remedy: the new ability to model minds, over-applied to the self, corrected by **evidence about real minds** (the headcount) and by **one real mind staying present** (the witness). Counselling supplies both, in that order, in the weather the sentence arrives in.

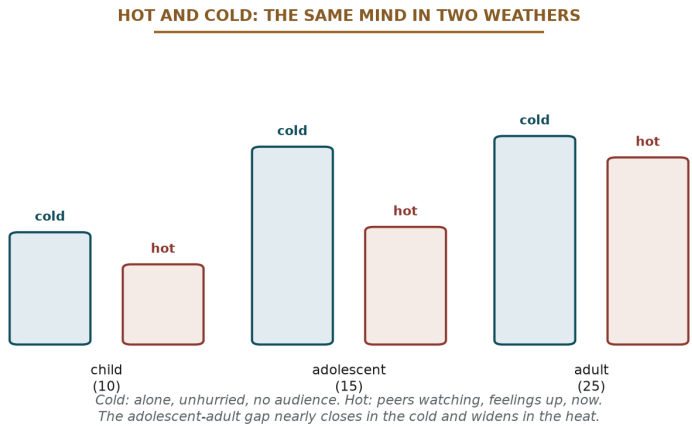


Figure 4.1 Hot and cold cognition: decision quality by age in cold conditions (alone, unhurried) and hot conditions (peers watching, feelings up); the adolescent-adult gap nearly closes in the cold and widens in the heat. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

Lecture III — Decisions under heat: the divergence point

Adolescent decision research converges on a pattern the counsellor can use forensically: in cold conditions adolescents' reasoning approaches adults'; in hot conditions it diverges, and the divergence is greatest where peer evaluation is present. The clinical method is to locate the **divergence point** in the narrative — the sentence at which the decision left the cold: "then Tunde looked at me", "then she said my name in that voice", "then the group went quiet". Before the point, the adolescent's own reasoning is usually sound and quotable; after it, the audience and the arousal govern.

Three interventions follow, in order. **Reconstruct the cold:** have the adolescent narrate their own pre-point reasoning aloud, in their words, and record it —

the file now contains proof of competence that the post-point disaster obscured, and the adolescent hears their own cold mind, which is the strongest anti-fable evidence available. **Arrange the heat:** identify the two or three situational variables that moved the decision (audience, substance, hour, phone in hand) and engineer them for the next equivalent situation — a leaving time, a peer pair, a phone rule, a route; the plan is written with the adolescent, because an arrangement imposed is an arrangement evaded. **Rehearse the hinge:** the single sentence the adolescent will say at the divergence point next time ("I'm leaving at ten"), rehearsed aloud twice in session, because a sentence rehearsed in the cold is retrievable in the heat and a sentence invented in the heat is not.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Hot-cognition analysis must never become consent analysis in reverse: where an adolescent's "decision" occurred under coercion, exploitation or an adult's grooming, the heat was manufactured by another person and the child is a victim, not a decision-maker. The divergence-point method applied to grooming locates the adult's engineering — and the record must say so in those words, because the file may one day be the child's evidence.

Worked example 4.1 — The assembly refusal, headcounted

Task. Ada (14) refuses to attend morning assembly because "everyone will see me walk in late and look at my skin". Work the imaginary audience as hypothesis, in order.

Solution. Witness first: "Being looked at has become a kind of pain for you. I am not going to argue you out of it today." Then the headcount, as three testable questions rather than a challenge: (i) *Who, exactly, is everyone?* — the assembly has four hundred pupils; Ada names three who might look. (ii) *What would they see?* — a girl walking in late; Ada's own prediction includes "they will see my face shining", and the question "shining how, at eight in the morning, in that light?" begins the evidence work about the skin itself (week 6's strand joins here). (iii) *What do they do in the next minute?* — Ada's answer, after thought: "they look at the person singing at the front." The audience survives the headcount as three names and one minute, which is bearable; the four-hundred abstraction was not. The arrangement: entry by the side door with the late-book for two weeks (the heat reduced while the evidence accumulates), and one rehearsed hinge sentence for the day she walks in the main door: "I'm late; I'm here." The falsifier, dated: if the refusal generalises beyond assembly to classrooms within three weeks, the audience is not the governing mirror and the formulation turns to week 7's internalising strand.

Worked example 4.2 — Kelvin's divergence point

Task. Reconstruct the phone-snatch narrative to the divergence point and write the arrangement plan with Kelvin.

Solution. Cold segment, in Kelvin's words: "I knew the plan was stupid from the start; I said I would only carry the bag." The competence is on the record. Divergence point, located at one sentence: "then the owner shouted and the boys looked at me to move." Audience plus arousal plus a role ("the one who moves") — the hot trio. Post-point, the reasoning function is absent from the narrative, which is the signature, not a moral verdict. The arrangement plan, written **with** him and signed: a leaving time from any gathering where the set assembles after dark (ten, with a code message to the auntie that costs him no face); a peer pair — one named cousin who walks his route; the bag rule stated as his own sentence ("I don't carry for anybody; my hands stay empty") rehearsed twice aloud; and the hinge for the shout-moment: "I'm not the one; I'm going." Consequences for the offence proceed separately and fairly, and the file holds both: the accountability and the divergence map. Review at eight weeks against one observable — hands empty, messages sent — and against the falsifier: an incident inside an arranged situation reopens the peer-set question of week 9.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 4 — the divergence interview. In pairs, one narrates a real adolescent decision from a supplied transcript while the other interviews for the divergence point using three questions only: what were you thinking just before? who was there, and what could they see? what changed in your body at that sentence? Record the point, the two situational variables, and one rehearsed hinge sentence. Swap. 250 words each; the mark is for locating the point at a sentence, not at a mood.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A decision case analysis of 900 words: for a supplied hot-cognition incident, reconstruct cold reasoning verbatim, locate the divergence point at a sentence, name the heat variables, and write the three-part plan (reconstruct, arrange, rehearse) with a dated falsifier — plus one paragraph on whether the heat was manufactured by another person, and what changes if it was.

Criterion	Weight
Cold reasoning quoted, competence visible	25%
Divergence point located at a sentence with evidence	25%
Heat variables named; plan in three parts, rehearsed hinge included	30%

Criterion	Weight
Coercion question asked and answered	20%

Formative. Write your own adolescent personal fable in one sentence, and the witness sentence you needed at fifteen.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Formal operations hand the adolescent the hypothetical and the ideal, and with them the critique of everything including the self; egocentrism's two mirrors — the imaginary audience and the personal fable — are the new mind-modelling over-applied, corrected by headcount and by witness; and decisions diverge from the adolescent's own cold reasoning at an identifiable hot point, so the work is to reconstruct the cold, arrange the heat and rehearse the hinge — unless the heat was manufactured by another person, in which case the child is a victim and the file says so.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Elkind, D. (1967). Egocentrism in adolescence. *Child Development, 38*(4), 1025–1034.
- Gardner, M., & Steinberg, L. (2005). Peer influence on risk taking, risk preference, and risky decision making in adolescence and adulthood: An experimental study. *Developmental Psychology, 41*(4), 625–635.
- Piaget, J., & Inhelder, B. (1969). *The psychology of the child*. Basic Books. — the formal-operational chapters, re-read for adolescence.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the decision-making chapters.

Seminar questions

1. An adolescent dismantles your argument with formal logic and then acts against it at night. Which week's material explains the gap, and which explains the bridge?
2. The personal fable as solitude requires witness before headcount. Why is the order clinical and not merely kind?
3. Locate a divergence point in your own adolescence at one sentence. What were the two heat variables?
4. Where does hot-cognition analysis shade into victim-blaming, and what sentence marks the border?
5. Adolescent idealism finds every arrangement wanting. What in your service deserves the critique?

Next week

Week 5 follows the ideal into identity: Erikson's crisis, Marcia's statuses, and the ethnic, religious, sexual and digital identities an adolescent must assemble into one self.

5 LECTURE UNIT 5 Teaching week 5 4 notional hours

Identity: The Crisis That Is Not a Crisis

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Explain** Erikson's identity versus role confusion as a developmental task with a social precondition — the moratorium — and state who is granted one and who is not.
2. **Apply** Marcia's four statuses to one adolescent across three domains, and use status-language as description rather than rank.
3. **Describe** ethnic and religious identity development and their protective function under discrimination, and counsel across a difference you do not share.
4. **Hold** sexual orientation and gender identity development with accuracy: the diversity of trajectories, the minority-stress mechanism, and the evidence on affirmation.
5. **Interview** an adolescent about identity in their own registers — faith, work, friendship, digital self — without importing the textbook's domain list.

Where this week sits

Identity is adolescence's signature task: the assembly of the child's identifications, talents, loyalties and shames into a self that can hold under pressure and make promises. This week moves from Erikson's crisis to Marcia's statuses to the identities that carry the most weight and the most risk in real adolescent lives — ethnic, religious, sexual, gendered, digital — and installs the interviewing discipline that lets a counsellor hear which identity is actually in crisis, because it is rarely the one the referral names.

Key concepts

IDENTITY V ROLE CONFUSION

Erikson's fifth crisis: the integration of childhood identifications and new capacities into a coherent self with commitments, against the confusion of a self that cannot cohere or commit. Its virtue is fidelity — the capacity to be loyal to people and to promises. In the room: the question beneath most adolescent distress — not "what is wrong?" but "who am I, and who will let me be it?"

MORATORIUM
The socially granted pause in which identity may be explored without penalty: the gap-year, the apprenticeship, the permitted doubt. Moratoriums are distributed unequally — by class, gender, culture and economy — and where none is granted, identity forecloses early or confuses long. In the room: the structural sentence behind "why has she not decided?" — because nothing around her can afford the question.

IDENTITY STATUSES
Marcia's crossing of exploration and commitment: diffusion (neither), foreclosure (commitment without exploration), moratorium (exploration without commitment), achievement (both). Statuses are positions within domains, not traits of persons: the same adolescent may be achieved in friendship, foreclosed in vocation and in moratorium on faith. In the room: a map fine-grained enough to counsel with.

MINORITY STRESS
The chronic excess stress carried by members of a stigmatised identity — enacted, anticipated and internalised — over and above ordinary stress; the mechanism beneath the elevated distress of discriminated-against adolescents, and the reason their distress is not evidence of identity pathology but of social conduct. In the room: the sentence that relocates the treatment from the child to the environment.

Lecture I — Erikson's task and its social precondition

Proposition 1. Identity is assembled, not discovered. The materials are the child's identifications (the mother's voice, the father's trade, the teacher's standard), the adolescent's new capacities (week 4′s instrument), and the society's available roles; the work is integration into a self that can keep a promise across situations. Role confusion is not rebellion but incoherence: a self whose parts cannot be in one room.

Proposition 2. The moratorium is a privilege with a price list. Societies grant pauses unevenly: the apprentice boy, the university-bound girl, the novice in the church; and deny them to the child who must earn at thirteen, marry at fifteen, or care for siblings at twelve. Where no moratorium exists, foreclosure is not a failure of exploration but an adaptation to necessity — and the counsellor who pathologises foreclosure in a child with no pause has blamed the child for the economy.

Proposition 3. Fidelity is the virtue, and fidelity is testable. Erikson's strength of this stage is the capacity for loyalty — to people, to causes, to a self-description held across pressure. The adolescent's fierce loyalties (to the group, the

faith, the friend, the team) are therefore not symptoms to moderate but the stage's product in formation; the work is widening the object of fidelity, not cooling the capacity.

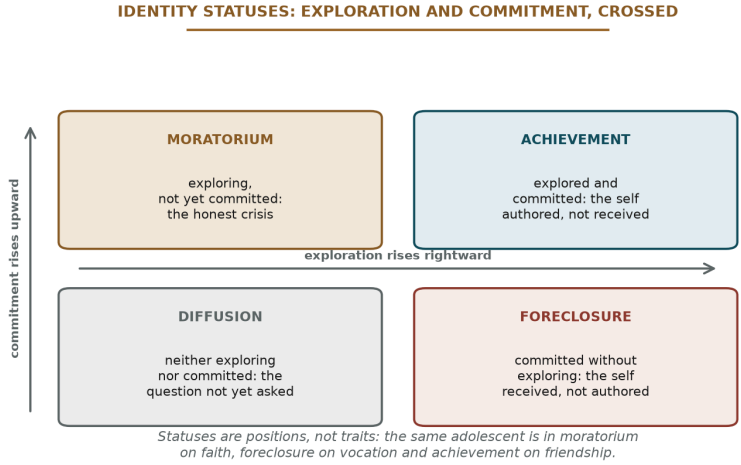


Figure 5.1 Marcia's identity statuses: exploration and commitment crossed, yielding moratorium, achievement, diffusion and foreclosure; positions within domains rather than traits of persons. After Marcia (1966). *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Map status in three domains per adolescent — vocation, faith or meaning, belonging — and write the domain beside each status. "Foreclosed" alone is an adjective; "foreclosed in vocation, moratorium in faith, achieved in belonging" is a formulation.

Lecture II — The identities that carry weight

Ethnic and racial identity develops through Phinney's sequence — unexamined, search, achieved — and under discrimination it carries a protective function: a achieved ethnic identity buffers the internalising cost of enacted and anticipated stigma, which is why the work with a discriminated-against adolescent includes the identity's pride strand and not only the wound strand. The counsellor across a difference they do not share does not claim the experience; they claim the obligation to know its shape: what the child is called, by whom, at what hour, and which adult in the building knows.

Religious identity in communities of faith is often the first available moratorium — the permitted doubt inside instruction — and the adolescent's religious questioning is frequently the safest form their identity work can take. Counsel that treats religious doubt as risk, or as compliance depending on the counsellor's

own position, has misread the domain; the clinical question is whether the doubt is explored (moratorium, healthy) or foreclosed in either direction by fear.

Sexual orientation and gender identity develop on diverse trajectories with no single sequence and no required disclosure; what the evidence supports firmly is the cost of rejection and the benefit of affirmation — family and school acceptance associate with markedly lower depression, self-harm and suicide risk among sexual- and gender-minority adolescents, and minority stress explains the elevated distress without recourse to any identity pathology. The counsellor's duties are ordered: safety first (who knows, and what happens to the child if others know), the child's own words and timetable for naming, accuracy about what care and community exist locally, and the family work that converts rejection into protection at the family's own pace — because the family is usually the child's only home.

Digital identity is not a separate identity but a new theatre for the same task: the curated self, the audience metrics, the permanence of the posted moment. The clinical grain is the gap between the curated self and the felt self — where the gap widens into shame, the theatre stops being rehearsal and becomes a mirror with a score (week 6).

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Identity disclosures carry safety geometry: a sexual or gender disclosure in a session creates an immediate question — who else knows, and what happens at home if the wrong person learns it first? The counsellor's confidentiality sentence (week 14) is stated before disclosures are likely, not after; and where the child's safety requires a family conversation, the child is in the room for it, in their own words, at a time they help choose — except in the one limit where life governs and the rule is said plainly.

Lecture III — Interviewing identity

The textbook domain list is a prompt, not a questionnaire. The interviewing discipline has four moves. **Open in the child's registers:** "who are you, when you are most yourself?" — and follow the answer's vocabulary (football, choir, the market stall, the game clan) rather than translating it into domains. **Locate the commitments:** "what would you defend, even against your friends?" — fidelity's objects appear quickly and they are the self's load-bearing walls. **Locate the explorations:** "what are you still deciding about, that nobody is allowed to rush?" — the moratorium's contents, and the place the counselling can protect. **Locate the confiscations:** "what have you had to stop being, or hide, to stay safe or stay loved?" — the identity work that is not crisis but casualty, and usually the true referral beneath the referral.

The record carries the child's own words for each of the four, because identity formulations written in professional vocabulary are identity formulations about a stranger.

Worked example 5.1 — Ada's three domains

Task. Map Ada (14) in Marcia's statuses across vocation, meaning and belonging, from the semester's accumulating record, and name the governing strand.

Solution. *Belonging:* achieved until the senior-school move — choir, two named friends, a pew — and now under active loss: the choir left, one friend moved classes, the pew unchanged but "the looking" makes it hard to walk in; status slipping from achieved toward diffusion under attack, which is why the loss reads as bereavement rather than transition. *Meaning:* foreclosed-in-the-good-sense until this year (faith received and held), now quietly in moratorium — two questions in session about whether God "sees the looking too", which is exploration, not collapse, and is to be protected rather than answered. *Vocation:* diffusion, age-appropriate at fourteen, except that the household's economics make foreclosure likely within two years (trade apprenticeship assumed); the file notes the assumption as a future foreclosure to keep in view, not a present problem. Governing strand: belonging under attack, because its loss is recent, concrete and reachable — the choir's return on her terms (week 2′s formulation) and one friendship deliberately re-watered; the meaning moratorium is protected by not being rushed; the vocation question is diarised for SS3. The falsifier: if the belonging work succeeds and the low mood persists at six weeks, the governing strand was internalising all along and week 7′s assessment opens.

Worked example 5.2 — Kelvin's fidelity, widened

Task. Kelvin's loyalties are to his peer set — the same set whose evenings carry his risk. Counsel without demanding disloyalty.

Solution. The set is not a mistake to remove but the stage's product in formation: fidelity itself, attached to the only people who have reliably chosen him. An intervention that demands betrayal of them demands betrayal of the capacity his adulthood will run on. The work widens the object rather than cooling the capacity: (i) name the fidelity aloud and honour it — "you don't leave people; that is the best thing about you, and it is going to matter at thirty"; (ii) add objects rather than subtract them — the auntie's household as a loyalty he already carries but has never named as such, the repeating class as a debt to his own fourteen-year-old self who passed; (iii) give the fidelity a test it can pass without the set: the code-message leaving time reframed not as obedience but as keeping a promise to the auntie — "she waits up; your message lets her sleep; that is loyalty, not reporting"; (iv) protect the set-relationship from counselling's gossip: nothing about individual members is discussed with the family, so his trust in the room

does not become another betrayal. Review at eight weeks against one observable: messages sent, and one sentence from him about who else he is loyal to. The falsifier: if the set's evenings escalate to carrying (week 4's bag rule broken twice), the widening has failed and the conversation turns to exit with face — a route out that lets him leave without disloyalty, which exists in every set and must be found with him, not for him.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 5 — the identity interview. In pairs, conduct the four-move interview on a supplied adolescent transcript or a peer in role: most-self register, commitments, explorations, confiscations. Record four verbatim sentences. Then write the three-domain status map with domains named, and one sentence naming the governing strand. 300 words plus the four quotations. The mark is for the child's words surviving into the map.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. An identity-status interview record: your four verbatim quotations, the three-domain map, the governing strand with its falsifier, and 400 words on which moratorium this adolescent is and is not granted, by whom, and what your service can do about the denial.

Criterion	Weight
Child's words verbatim in all four moves	30%
Statuses mapped per domain, not globally	25%
Governing strand argued with falsifier	25%
Moratorium audit structural, not sentimental	20%

Formative. Write your own adolescent identity in one sentence of each move — and note which move was hardest to answer. That is the move your clients will hide.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Identity is the assembly of a self that can keep promises; its crisis requires a moratorium that societies grant unevenly, so foreclosure is often economics rather than failure; Marcia's statuses map it finely enough to counsel with; ethnic, religious, sexual, gendered and digital identities carry the weight and the risk, with minority stress relocating distress from the child to the environment and affirmation carrying the evidence; and the interview that reaches any of it runs in the child's registers — most-self, commitments, explorations, confiscations — with their words kept verbatim into the file.

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- Erikson, E. H. (1968). *Identity: Youth and crisis*. W. W. Norton.
- Marcia, J. E. (1966). Development and validation of ego-identity status. *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology, 3*(5), 551–558.
- Phinney, J. S. (1990). Ethnic identity in adolescents and adults: Review of research. *Psychological Bulletin, 108*(3), 499–514.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the identity chapter.
- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N., Taiwo, K., ... Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478.

Seminar questions

1. Which moratorium were you granted at fifteen, and who paid for it?
2. Foreclosure in a child with no pause: why is "identity foreclosed" the wrong adjective, and what is the right sentence?
3. Minority stress relocates distress to the environment. What does that make the counsellor's client list?
4. An adolescent's religious doubt is exploration. What would tell you it was fear instead, in either direction?
5. The confiscation question usually finds the true referral. What will you do with the answer when it names an adult in the building?

Next week

Week 6 follows the ideal into the self's mirror: esteem trajectories, body image, and the comparison machine that scores the adolescent against strangers all day.

6 LECTURE UNIT 6 Teaching week 6 4 notional hours

Self, Esteem and the Body Under the Comparison Machine

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Describe** self-concept differentiation in adolescence and the self-esteem trajectory with its early-adolescent dip and its gender gap.
2. **Explain** the comparison machine: social comparison, curated feeds and audience metrics as a developmental instrument turned hostile, and name what it measures and what it cannot.

3. **Assess** body-image difficulty and its gradients, distinguishing normative dissatisfaction from clinical presentation, and locate the eating-disorder red flags.
4. **Counsel** with esteem's two levers — competence in valued domains and relationship that does not score — rather than with praise that inflates and then collapses.
5. **Design** one household or school change that reduces metric exposure without confiscation battles.

Where this week sits

Week 4 gave the adolescent the ideal; week 5 gave the ideal a name — identity. This week asks what happens when the ideal is aimed at the self: the self-concept splits into selves for each audience, esteem dips as the mirrors multiply, the body becomes the most public and most scored of all the selves, and a machine arrives — the feed — that industrialises comparison at a scale no previous adolescence met. The counsellor's work is to restore the two levers esteem actually runs on, and to disarm the machine without confiscating the phone, because the phone is also the child's village.

Key concepts

SELF-CONCEPT DIFFERENTIATION
The adolescent's discovery that they are different selves in different relationships — with mother, with peers, with the teacher, online — and the early distress of the inconsistencies ("which one is me?"). Integration across audiences is the task; fragmentation under incompatible audiences is the risk. In the room: the sentence beneath "they don't know the real me" — sometimes true, sometimes the true me not yet assembled.

ESTEEM DIP
Self-esteem falls for many children in the early-adolescent transition — new school, new mirrors, puberty's timing — and recovers across the teens; the dip is deeper on average for girls, and the gap tracks bodies, audiences and domains valued rather than any difference in worth. In the room: the pattern, not the level, is the finding — a low level that is stable is a different formulation from a falling one.

COMPARISON MACHINE
The industrialisation of social comparison: curated selves, algorithmic feeds, and countable audiences (likes, views, streaks) that convert the imaginary audience of week 4 into a dashboard. The machine measures engagement, not worth; but the adolescent's developing system reads the dashboard as the audience's verdict, hour

by hour. In the room: why the two-a-morning loop now arrives with numbers attached.

ESTEEM LEVERS

The two processes that actually build esteem: competence in domains the adolescent values (not the domains adults value), and relationships that do not score — being known and held without metric. Praise that inflates ("you are the best") collapses at the first comparison; praise that describes effort and specific competence survives, and relationship outlasts both. In the room: the counsel to parents who have been feeding the machine with scores.

Lecture I — The differentiated self and its dip

Proposition 1. Differentiation precedes integration and costs distress. The child's unitary self-concept splits in early adolescence into audience-relative selves; the inconsistencies are felt as falseness until integration arrives later in the teens. Where audiences are compatible the integration is ordinary; where they are hostile to each other — the home self and the peer self that cannot meet, the faith self and the online self — the adolescent carries incompatible selves and the cost is shame or exhaustion, not confusion alone.

Proposition 2. The dip is contextual and the gap is meaningful. The early-adolescent esteem dip tracks the transition's new mirrors; its greater depth for girls tracks which bodies and behaviours the mirrors score, and the domains in which girls' competence is publicly valued. The pattern-level finding counsels against panic at a single low score and for attention to a falling trajectory across two terms.

Proposition 3. Domains are weighted by the child, not by the adult. Esteem is domain-specific and weighted by personal importance: a girl whose esteem rests on choir and friendship loses more in the choir's collapse than any report card can restore. Assessment therefore maps the child's own domain weights before any intervention, because an intervention in an unweighted domain is an intervention in a stranger's self.

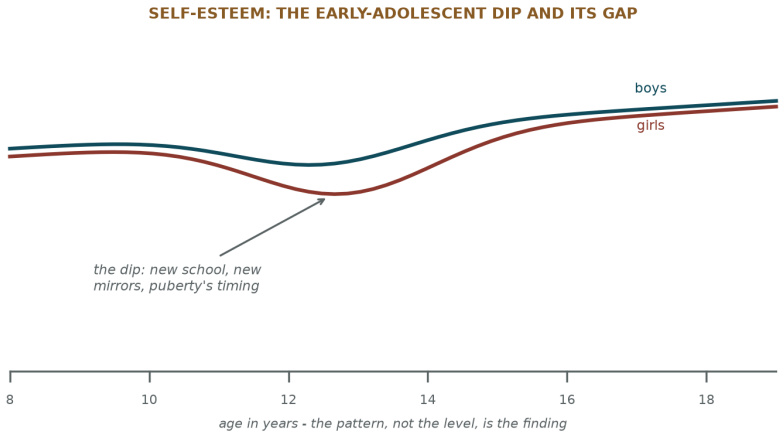


Figure 6.1 Self-esteem trajectories by gender across ages 8-18: the early-adolescent dip and its gender gap; the pattern, not the level, is the finding. *Source:* prepared for this edition, schematic of the cohort pattern.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. Map the adolescent's esteem domains and weights in their own words — "what would hurt most to lose?" — before any esteem work. The list is the self's load-bearing wall schedule.

Lecture II — The comparison machine, precisely

The machine has three parts and each has a different intervention. **Curation:** the feed presents idealised selves — filtered bodies, staged moments, selected successes — as ordinary life; the adolescent compares their interior with others' exteriors, which is a comparison no human can win. Intervention is literacy, not confiscation: the feed deconstructed item by item in session ("who took this? how many were deleted? what was happening one minute later?"), because a deconstructed image loses its verdict-power. **Metrics:** counts convert the week-4 imaginary audience into a dashboard with numbers; the numbers measure engagement and algorithmic timing, not worth, but the developing system reads verdict. Intervention is architectural: notifications off during homework and after a set hour, the counts hidden where the platform allows, and one metric-free zone daily — the meal, the choir, the pitch — where no audience exists because no device does. **Algorithm:** the feed optimises for engagement and therefore for emotion, and negative comparison is engaging; the adolescent experiences the algorithm's business model as their own unworthiness. Intervention is the sentence that relocates the cause: "you are not the problem the feed found; you are the product it is selling attention around" — which, said once with evidence, is durable in adolescents

because it recruits their formal-operational critique (week 4) on the machine's behalf rather than their own.

The machine is not only harm: it is also the village — the diaspora cousin, the choir group, the study thread, the identity community a small town cannot supply. Confiscation removes the village with the verdict; the work is architecture that keeps the village and starves the dashboard.

Lecture III — The body: normative dissatisfaction and its red flags

Body dissatisfaction in adolescence is normative in the statistical sense and harmful in the developmental one: most adolescents, girls markedly more, report wishing something about their body different, and the dissatisfaction tracks the mirrors rather than the body. The clinical line is not dissatisfaction versus none but **grip**: dissatisfaction that organises the day — food restriction, avoided rooms, abandoned sport, the deleted photograph, the refused assembly — has grip, and grip is the referral criterion.

The red flags that end waiting: restriction with weight loss or growth faltering; purging or compensatory exercise; the adolescent who will not eat in company; exercise that continues through injury and fever; and, in boys, the muscularity-directed variant — the protein powders, the mirror hours, the rage at missed sessions — which is under-recognised because it wears the costume of discipline. Comorbidity is the rule: body grip with depression, with perfectionism, with the trauma history that makes the body a scene rather than a self.

The counsel to families runs on the two levers and three prohibitions: no commentary on anyone's body in the house, including the parents' own; no weighing as punishment or reward; no food policing at the table — the table is relationship, and relationship is the lever that outlasts the others. Where grip is present, the referral pathway of week 13 opens with medical review first, because eating difficulty is the one adolescent presentation where the body's state can outrun the counselling.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Body and feed material carries two safeguarding edges: image-based abuse — the shared intimate image, the edited humiliation — is conduct by others with legal edges, and the child is a victim whatever the image's origin; and pro-harm communities (restriction, self-harm techniques) recruit through the same feeds, so a feed audit is part of assessment where grip or self-harm is present, conducted with the adolescent's collaboration rather than by seizure, because a seized phone is a lost village and a lost disclosure route.

Worked example 6.1 — Ada's domain weights and the choir

Task. Map Ada's esteem domains, locate the machine's contribution, and write the two-lever plan.

Solution. Weights, in her words: choir ("where I am my voice"), friendship ("Blessing only"), school ("I am average and it is fine"), home ("I am the quiet one"). The load-bearing walls are choir and one friendship — and both are currently damaged: the choir by the looking (week 2), the friendship by class separation and Ada's withdrawal. The machine's contribution, audited with her: an hour nightly on a feed of choir pages and school confession pages; the counts watched, not posted — she is a reader, not a poster, and the reader's injury is comparison without the village's reply. Plan, two levers: competence — the choir's return engineered on her terms (entry from the back, one named friend beside her, the solo declined this term and accepted next, her choosing); relationship — Blessing re-watered by one standing weekly errand together at the market, the auntie's household named aloud as a wall ("you are the quiet one **here**; here you are also the one Bisi calls first"). Machine architecture, without confiscation: the confession pages unfollowed together in session (she laughs at the third one — the deconstruction working), notifications off after nine, and the market errand as the daily metric-free zone. Falsifier, dated: if at six weeks the choir has returned and the mood has not moved, the governing strand is internalising (week 7) and the formulation reorders; if the feed audit finds pro-harm communities, week 13 opens the same week.

Worked example 6.2 — The father's scores

Task. Kelvin's late father's brother visits monthly and ranks the boys' results aloud at the family meal. Kelvin's esteem in school domains is low and falling; he has stopped bringing books home. Counsel the household.

Solution. The ranking is the machine in its oldest form: a metric, delivered publicly, by a person the child loves and cannot answer. Three moves with the household, the uncle present. First, honour the intention and name the mechanism: "You rank them because you want them to rise. The ranking does the opposite — it teaches Kelvin that school is a place where he is read aloud and found small, so he has stopped bringing the evidence home." Second, replace the metric with the two levers: competence in a domain Kelvin weights — the goalkeeper's return of week 2 is now the family's public pride, announced at the meal in the ranking's old slot, so the ritual's force is recruited rather than fought; and relationship without score — one monthly walk with the uncle in which results are forbidden and football talk is mandatory, because the boy needs the man more than the man's table needs the numbers. Third, the prohibition stated once and kindly: no child's result read aloud in this house again; results are the

child's to tell, in their own time, to whom they choose. The falsifier is behavioural and dated: books home, or not, within four weeks; and one sentence from Kelvin about the walk, which is the lever that will still be working at twenty-five.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 6 — the feed audit, collaborative. With a supplied case record or role-play: conduct a collaborative feed audit — what is followed, what is watched, what is posted, which hours, which communities; deconstruct two curated items item-by-item in session language; and write the architecture plan (notifications, counts, metric-free zone, village preserved). 300 words. The mark is for the village surviving the architecture.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A self-concept map and machine plan of 1,000 words: domain weights in the child's words, esteem trajectory (level versus pattern), the machine's three parts audited with an intervention each, the body grip assessment with red flags checked, and the two-lever plan with a dated falsifier.

Criterion	Weight
Domains and weights in the child's words	25%
Trajectory read as pattern; gap explained contextually	20%
Machine audited in three parts, village preserved	25%
Body grip assessed, red flags checked	15%
Two-lever plan concrete with falsifier	15%

Formative. Write the one sentence you would say to a parent who posts their child's results and photographs publicly, and loves them.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The adolescent self differentiates into audience-relative selves whose integration is the task; esteem dips in the early transition with a gender gap that tracks mirrors and valued domains; the comparison machine industrialises the imaginary audience into a dashboard that measures engagement and is read as verdict; body dissatisfaction becomes clinical at grip, with red flags that end waiting; and esteem is rebuilt on its two levers — competence in the child's valued domains and relationship that does not score — with architecture that starves the dashboard while keeping the village.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Harter, S. (1999). *The construction of the self: A developmental perspective*. Guilford Press.
- Odgers, C. L., & Jensen, M. R. (2020). Annual Research Review: Adolescent mental health in the digital age: Facts, fears, and future directions. *Journal of Child Psychology and Psychiatry, 61*(3), 336–352.
- Rosenberg, M. (1965). *Society and the adolescent self-image*. Princeton University Press.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the self chapters.

Seminar questions

1. Which audience-relative self of your own adolescence could never meet the others, and what did the incompatibility cost?
2. The machine is also the village. Where is the line in an architecture plan, and who draws it — you or the adolescent?
3. Body dissatisfaction is normative and harmful. How do you say both sentences to a parent without cancelling either?
4. Praise that inflates collapses at the first comparison. Write one inflating sentence and its describing replacement.
5. What does your service score, publicly, that it should stop?

Next week

Week 7 follows the self into feeling: the internalising gap, emotion regulation under new weather, and the conversations about self-harm and suicide that save lives when they are had plainly.

7 LECTURE UNIT 7 Teaching week 7 4 notional hours

Emotion, Internalising, and the Conversations That Save Lives

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Explain** the internalising gap — depression's and anxiety's emergence and gender divergence in adolescence — as timing, weather and treatment of weather rather than as weakness.
2. **Describe** adolescent emotion regulation: the intensities of week 3's weather with its regulatory instrument still under construction, and the strategies that are adaptive in adolescence.

3. **Assess** depression, anxiety presentations, and self-harm function in an adolescent, distinguishing normative intensity from clinical presentation and naming the red flags.
4. **Conduct** the risk conversation: asking about suicide directly, in plain language, without planting and without flinching, and documenting what is done with the answer.
5. **Build** a safety plan with an adolescent that they can use at two in the morning, and know the limits of your role.

Where this week sits

Adolescence's most consequential clinical event is the first internalising episode: the majority of lifetime depression and anxiety disorders begin before adulthood, and adolescence is their peak onset window. This week supplies the epidemiology, the regulation science, the assessment and — the reason the week exists — the conversations: the direct risk question, the function-seeking inquiry about self-harm, the safety plan built with rather than for the adolescent, and the family sentences that turn a household from an audience into a support. These are the most teachable hours in the programme, because they are the ones most often not had.

Key concepts

INTERNALISING GAP
The epidemiological fact of adolescence: depression and anxiety emerge and rise sharply from early adolescence, and from that point prevalence is roughly twice as high among girls as boys — a gap that opens at puberty and tracks timing (earlier transitions), weather (rumination, co-rumination), body scoring and treatment of distress rather than any difference in capacity to feel. In the room: why week 3's storm matters clinically, not just developmentally.

RUMINATION
The repetitive, passive focus on distress and its causes and consequences — the style that converts weather into climate, predicted by adolescence's new capacity for sustained self-focus; it is more common among adolescent girls and is a robust predictor of depression's onset and persistence. In the room: the two-a-morning loop of week 3, and the one habit that most reliably converts a bad month into a disorder.

SELF-HARM FUNCTION
Non-suicidal self-injury's usual functions: regulation of unbearable feeling, punishment of a hated self, communication to an audience, or escape from numbness —

functions assessed by asking, not assumed; distinct from suicidal behaviour in intent while sharing risk, with a history of self-harm among the strongest single predictors of later suicide. In the room: the question that turns a scar from a scandal into a symptom with a grammar.

DIRECT RISK QUESTION
Asking about suicide plainly and without euphemism — "have you thought about killing yourself?" — which does not plant the idea (evidence consistently finds asking is safe and often relieving) and is the only reliable way to assess it. In the room: the sentence counsellors most fear and that saves the most lives; its absence, not its presence, is the risk.

Lecture I — The gap: what opens, when, and why

Proposition 1. Adolescence is the onset window. The bulk of lifetime depression and anxiety disorders have their first episode before adulthood, with incidence rising steeply from about the early teens; the disorders that will define many adult lives arrive while the brain is still assembling its brakes. This is the clinical sentence behind week 3′s construction site: the instrument is plastic, and plastic cuts both ways — it is the window of opportunity and of vulnerability.

Proposition 2. The gap opens at puberty and its causes are social-developmental, not intrinsic. From early adolescence, girls' rates of depression and anxiety run roughly twice boys'. The tracks: earlier and more off-timed transitions (week 2′s meaning machinery); rumination and co-rumination styles that convert weather into climate; the body's new public scoring (week 6); and a treatment of distress — in girls, talk and analysis; in boys, distraction and suppression — in which the first two can deepen the hole before they drain it. Boys' internalising is under-detected rather than absent: it presents as anger, conduct, substance and absence, and is recorded in other people's categories.

Proposition 3. Comorbidity and masking are the rule. Internalising rarely travels alone: anxiety and depression overlap heavily with each other, with trauma reactions, with the sleep debt of week 3, and — in boys especially — with conduct presentations that mask it. The assessment therefore never stops at the presenting register; it asks what lives underneath anger, absence and achievement alike.

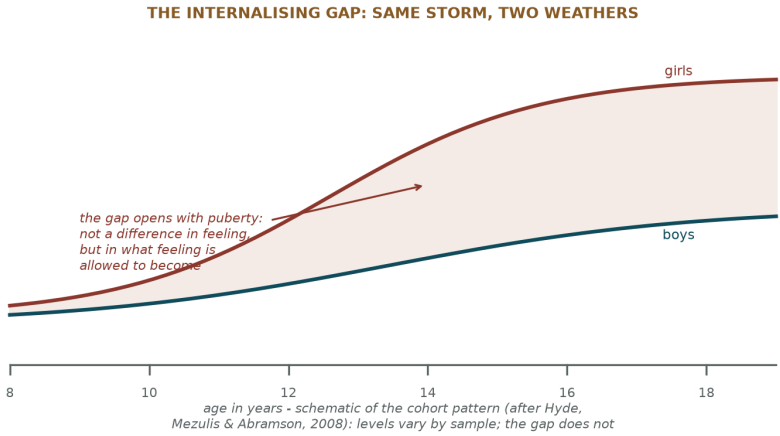


Figure 7.1 The internalising gap: schematic trajectories of girls' and boys' distress from age 8 to 18, the gap opening at puberty. *Source:* prepared for this edition, schematic of the cohort pattern (after Hyde, Mezulis & Abramson, 2008).

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. In every adolescent assessment, ask the internalising questions underneath the presenting category — including in the angry boy and the high-achieving girl, whose presentations are the two the gap hides best.

Lecture II — Regulation, and what helps

Regulation in adolescence runs on three instruments at unequal maturity: the behavioural repertoire learned in childhood (distraction, seeking, problem-solving), the new but still-developing cognitive instrument of week 3 (reframing, reappraisal, perspective-taking), and the peer instrument — co-regulation, which adolescents use more than children or adults and which is powerful in both directions: co-rumination deepens, co-action and companionship relieve.

What helps, in order of leverage: *sleep first* — the debt of week 3 is not background; irregular and short sleep predicts and maintains adolescent depression, and no regulation strategy works well on a sleep-deprived brain. *Behavioural activation* — the scheduled, valued, mastery-or-connection-bearing activities that depression cancels first and recovery needs first; in adolescence the schedule must recruit the domains the child weights (week 6), not the domains the adult would choose. *Rumination interruption* — the loop broken by doing rather than by arguing: movement, company, a task with hands; argued-against rumination becomes more rumination. *Cognitive work with the new instrument* — the divergence-point analysis of week 4 (what actually happened, what the loop added) now works because formal operations has arrived; before that it is consolation,

after it, it is a tool. *The relationships that do not score* — week 6′s second lever, which in depression is the load-bearing wall: one adult who knows, one peer who stays.

What does not help: advice-giving in the first ten minutes; minimising ("at your age, what is there to be sad about?" — which teaches the child the weather is a verdict); the interrogation of the loop rather than its interruption; and, above all, waiting for it to pass because adolescence is a storm. Some storms are weather; this week exists to teach which are climate.

Lecture III — The conversations

The risk conversation, directly. Ask plainly, without euphemism, in the adolescent's own language once you have it: "when it is at its worst, do you ever think about killing yourself?" Asking does not plant the idea — the evidence is consistent that direct asking is safe and is often met with relief that the question was finally asked. Then assess in the order of lethality: thoughts (how often, how long, how controllable), plans (how specific, how available the means), intent (what stops you — and the answer to "what stops you" is the protective list the safety plan is built from), and history (previous attempts, self-harm, family suicide — the strongest predictors). The answer is documented in the record plainly: what was asked, what was said, what was done. The limit of your role is stated in the service's escalation policy and to the child before it is needed: life governs the room; if the answer requires it, other adults will be involved, how and when will be told to the child first, and the child is never handed over like an object — they are accompanied.

The self-harm conversation, function-seeking. "Tell me what it does for you" — asked without shock, after the wound is cared for. Function governs intervention: regulation gets the interruption repertoire and the sleep work; punishment gets the self-relationship work of week 6′s levers; communication gets the family conversation the behaviour has been standing in for; escape from numbness gets the trauma assessment of week 13 beneath it. Means restriction is discussed with the household in language that does not shame the child: it is not confiscation of trust but the same principle as the bag on the windowsill in week 4 — heat needs friction removed, and the household removes it together with the child knowing.

The safety plan, built with. The adolescent's own plan, in their own words, on a card in their pocket: the early signs (theirs — "when the music stops sounding like anything"); the things that work alone (the loop-breakers: the walk, the cold water, the drill of a song); the people to contact in order (peer, adult, service) with numbers written, not remembered; and the professional contacts including the crisis line, with the one sentence rehearsed aloud in session so that using it at two in

the morning is not a first draft. The plan is reviewed and rewritten as the weather changes; a plan that is never revised was never used.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Where risk is present the record carries: the direct question asked and the answer given; the lethality assessment; the means-restriction conversation and with whom; the safety plan and its review date; the escalation performed and to whom; and the child's knowledge of every step. Where the child is at imminent risk, they are not left alone and the escalation is immediate — the accompaniment principle: the child goes with an adult, not to one.

Worked example 7.1 — The question Ada has been waiting for

Task. Ada's file now carries: six weeks of low mood, the choir loss, sleep to two a.m., one friend remaining, and — disclosed today, quietly, without being asked — "some nights I think it would be easier not to be here." Conduct and document the risk conversation.

Solution. *The direct question, in her language:* "When you think it would be easier not to be here — have you thought about killing yourself?" Answer: yes, sometimes, at night; "I would not do it to Bisi" — the protective list arrives in one name, and the plan will be built on it. *Lethality assessment:* thoughts present most nights, controllable "until about two"; no plan ("I have not thought about how"); no intent (Bisi; also, "I want to see SS3"); no attempts; no self-harm history; no family history known — to be checked with the auntie this week, framed as health history. *Function of the nights:* rumination + sleep debt + the looking (week 2) + two losses; the formulation writes climate-on-weather, and the intervention order is sleep first, choir restoration, Blessing re-watered, rumination interruption for the two-a.m. slot (the cold-water walk to the kitchen she already uses — named, scheduled, and the light left on for her). *Safety plan, with her, in her words:* signs ("when the music stops"); alone ("water, kitchen, sing anything quietly"); order ("Blessing first — but at two a.m. she sleeps — so Auntie Bisi, and the card has the service number"); rehearsed sentence said aloud twice in session. *Accompaniment:* the auntie is told this week — with Ada in the room, Ada's words used first ("she told me herself; this is what she said"), means conversation gentle (nothing to restrict; medicines locked as ordinary household practice, said as ordinary), and Ada's knowledge of every step recorded. *Documentation:* question asked, answer given, lethality assessed, plan built, review date in two weeks, auntie informed with Ada present. Falsifier: at two weeks, the nights are counted — if the two-a.m. slot has moved to four a.m., the plan is revised and escalation reviewed; if thoughts persist at six weeks despite sleep and restoration work, week 13 opens the clinical pathway with medical review.

Worked example 7.2 — Kelvin's scar and its grammar

Task. Kelvin, 16, shows the counsellor two healed cuts on his forearm: "everybody does it." Assess function; intervene without scandal.

Solution. *Function-seeking, after care and without shock:* "Tell me what it does for you." Answer, eventually: "when the heat is too much, it is something to do with it" — regulation; plus a communication edge: "at least somebody asks about this." The grammar is now known: unbearable feeling with no repertoire, and a household where distress is not spoken. *Intervention, function by function:* regulation — the interruption repertoire built with him from what already works (the pitch, the walk home the long way, cold water, drill — chosen by him, written on the card); sleep and substance audit (week 3's debt and the evenings of week 4 both raise the heat); communication — the family conversation the cuts have been standing in for, prepared in session and held with the auntie present, Kelvin's words first; and the self-relationship lever — one adult in the house who now knows, so the function "somebody asks" is met by a person rather than a wound. *Means:* discussed with the household plainly, without shaming him — the razor is not hunted but the household agrees to the ordinary: medicines and blades stored as stored, and the sentence said to Kelvin aloud: "this is not because we do not trust you; it is because heat needs friction removed, and we are removing it together." *Documentation and limits:* function assessed, plan built with review date, auntie informed with Kelvin present, no current suicidal intent reported — the direct question still asked, and its answer recorded, because "everybody does it" is a sentence that has covered both. Falsifier: fresh marks within eight weeks reopen the assessment at medical review; the plan's use — one card sentence Kelvin repeats back unprompted — is the sign it is working.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 7 — the risk conversation, rehearsed. In triads, rehearse on the supplied transcripts until the sentences are fluent: the direct question in the adolescent's language; the lethality sequence (thoughts, plan, intent, history); "what stops you" and building the plan's first line from the answer; the function question after a self-harm disclosure; and the accompaniment sentence to the family. Each counsellor rotates through all three roles. 400-word record of the rehearsal with the sentences you would keep verbatim. The mark is for fluency under the adolescent's silence and the family's panic — the two conditions under which unpractised counsellors lose the sentence.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A risk conversation record and safety plan of 1,200 words from a supplied case: the direct question and its documentation; lethality assessment in

order; the function-seeking inquiry; the safety plan in the adolescent's words with the rehearsed sentence; the family/accompaniment steps with the child's knowledge of each; and 300 words on the internalising gap's meaning for your service's intake questions.

Criterion	Weight
Direct question asked plainly, documented	25%
Lethality sequence complete and ordered	20%
Function assessed by asking, not assumed	15%
Safety plan in the adolescent's words, rehearsed	20%
Accompaniment and family steps, child informed	10%
Gap applied to service intake	10%

Formative. Write the one sentence you would use to open the risk question with a fifteen-year-old who has just said "it would be easier not to be here". Read it aloud. Revise it until it does not flinch.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. Adolescence is internalising's onset window: the gap opens at puberty and tracks timing, rumination, body scoring and treatment of distress, while boys' internalising hides in other people's categories; regulation runs on instruments of unequal maturity with sleep as the first lever and rumination interruption by doing rather than arguing; self-harm has a grammar whose functions are assessed by asking; and the conversations that save lives are the direct risk question, the function-seeking inquiry, the safety plan built with the adolescent in their words, and the accompaniment that informs the child of every step — documented plainly, rehearsed until fluent, and reviewed until the weather passes.

READING (APA 7TH)

- Hyde, J. S., Mezulis, A. H., & Abramson, L. Y. (2008). The ABCs of depression: Integrating affective, biological, and cognitive models to explain the emergence of the gender difference in depression. *Psychological Review, 115*(2), 291–313.
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- Nolen-Hoeksema, S. (2001). Gender differences in depression. *Current Directions in Psychological Science, 10*(5), 173–176.
- Patton, G. C., Sawyer, S. M., Santelli, J. S., Ross, D. A., Afifi, R., Allen, N. B., Arora, M., Azzopardi, P., Baldwin, W., Bonell, C., Kakuma, R., Kennedy, E., Mahon, J., McGovern, T., Mokdad, A. H., Patel, V., Petroni, S., Reavley, N.,

Taiwo, K., … Viner, R. M. (2016). Our future: A *Lancet* commission on adolescent health and wellbeing. *The Lancet, 387*(10036), 2423–2478.
- Steinberg, L. (2014). *Age of opportunity: Lessons from the new science of adolescence*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. — **core text**; the emotional-health chapters.

Seminar questions

1. Why is the absence of the direct question a greater risk than its presence? What makes counsellors fear it?
2. "What stops you" is the safety plan's first line. Whose name would have stopped you at fifteen, and what does that tell you about building plans?
3. Boys' internalising hides in anger and absence. Which intake question of your service would miss it?
4. Means restriction without shame: what exactly does the household say, and to whom first?
5. A safety plan never revised was never used. How will you know yours was?

Next week

Week 8 turns to the adolescent's first institutions: the family under renegotiation, autonomy and conflict's changed shape, and the counsellor's place at a table where everyone is right.

8 LECTURE UNIT 8 Teaching week 8 4 notional hours

The Family Under Renegotiation: Autonomy, Conflict and Connectedness

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this week you will be able to:

1. **Explain** the adolescent family transition as renegotiation rather than separation: autonomy and connectedness rising together, with individuation as the healthy form.
2. **Apply** the domain model of conflict — moral, conventional, prudential, personal — and use jurisdiction as a lever in family sessions.
3. **Describe** parenting styles and the developmental evidence for authoritative parenting, including the cultural qualifications, and counsel a household toward it without importing a foreign family.
4. **Conduct** a first family session with an adolescent present: seating, speaking order, the jurisdictional reframe, and the one agreement that survives the room.

5. **Recognise** the family presentations that end counselling-as-usual: maltreatment, loss, separation, parental illness, displacement, and household economies under strain.

Where this week sits

The adolescent does not develop inside a skull; they develop inside a household under renegotiation. This week takes the family from week 1′s widening gap — where it was an object of study — and makes it the room's second client: autonomy's real shape, conflict's changed grammar and its jurisdictional levers, parenting's evidence and its cultural qualifications, and the first-session discipline that lets an adolescent be present in their own family's counselling without becoming the exhibit. It closes the developmental half of the semester; weeks 9 to 12 widen outward to peers, aspirations, risk and culture, and weeks 13 to 16 gather everything into clinical practice.

Key concepts

RENEGOTIATION NOT SEPARATION
The correction to detachment theories: healthy adolescent development raises autonomy and connectedness together — individuation — rather than trading one for the other; the adolescent who separates completely has not individuated but withdrawn, and the household that permits no autonomy has not preserved connection but frozen it. In the room: the question that is never "how to let go" but "how to renegotiate".

DOMAIN MODEL
Smetana's finding that adolescents and parents agree on the legitimacy of parental authority in moral, conventional and prudential domains and dispute the personal domain — and that conflict concentrates exactly there: hair, room, music, messages, friends' names. Jurisdiction, once located, is the lever: most family conflict is not about values but about whose question it is. In the room: the map that turns a shouting match into a negotiation with an agenda.

AUTHORITATIVE PARENTING
High warmth and high demand: responsiveness with standards — the style associated across many samples with the best adolescent outcomes (competence, lower risk behaviour, better mental health), with cultural qualifications: in some communities higher directiveness carries the same warmth and the same outcomes, and "demandingness without warmth" (authoritarian) is the reliable risk, not structure as such.

In the room: the household's two dials, and the sentence that structure is not the enemy — coldness is.

CONNECTEDNESS AS PROTECTION

Family connectedness — being known, counted on, and mattering to the household — is among the strongest protective factors in adolescent mental health and risk behaviour, stronger than monitoring tactics and surviving conflict; conflict in a connected household is renegotiation, while conflict in a disconnected one is erosion. In the room: the variable to protect first, before any behavioural program.

Lecture I — Autonomy's real shape

Proposition 1. Individuation, not detachment. The separation-individuation tradition (Blos) captured a real process — the adolescent's second individuation, working through the childhood internal objects — but the detachment reading of it was wrong: the evidence shows emotional autonomy (de-idealising the parents, deciding for oneself) rising **with** connectedness, not instead of it. The adolescent who cannot argue with a parent has not become independent; they have given up on being known.

Proposition 2. Autonomy is three things and develops at three speeds. *Emotional* autonomy (the parents seen as people), *behavioural* autonomy (decisions made and owned), and *cognitive* autonomy (opinions formed and defended) — with behavioural autonomy's pace set culturally and economically as much as developmentally: the fourteen-year-old running a market stall carries decisional authority her university-bound cousin will not hold for eight years. The counsellor assesses all three separately, because the household usually grants or refuses them in bundles that no one has chosen.

Proposition 3. Monitoring works through knowledge, and knowledge through willingness. The parental-knowledge finding: what protects adolescents is not surveillance but parents' actual knowledge of the child's whereabouts, company and activities — and most of that knowledge is supplied voluntarily by the child, in households where telling is safe. Surveillance that damages connectedness destroys the supply of the very information it seeks; the code-message of week 4 works because it is a willing transmission, not a tracked one.

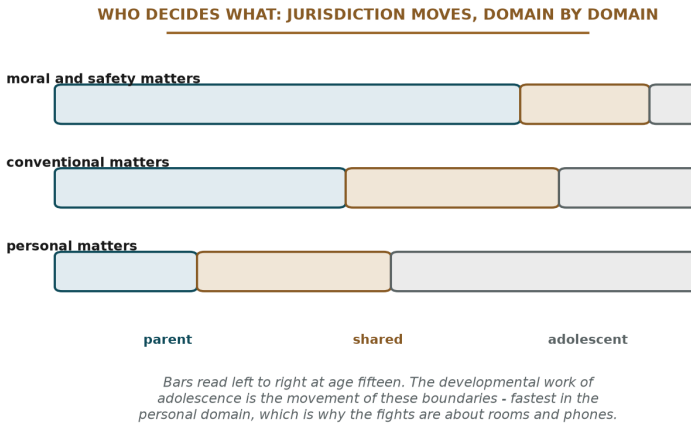


Figure 8.1 Family jurisdictions: moral, conventional, prudential and personal domains with authority concentrated in the first three and conflict concentrated in the fourth. After Smetana. *Source:* prepared for this edition.

PRACTICE NOTE

Clinical implication. In every family case, assess the three autonomies separately and ask where the child's knowledge-supply has stopped: what has the adolescent stopped telling, and what happened the last time they told?

Lecture II — Conflict's grammar and the jurisdictional lever

Adolescent-parent conflict rises in frequency in early adolescence, peaks in the early-to-mid teens, declines thereafter — and stays mild in most families: the "storm" reading of conflict was another exaggeration (week 1), though the rise is real and its timing tracks the domain dispute. The grammar: conflict concentrates in the **personal domain** — the body, the room, the music, the messages, the friends' names — because that is where the adolescent's jurisdiction claim has outrun the household's grant. Moral questions (harm, fairness) are not disputed; conventional questions (manners, respect forms) are disputed but negotiable; prudential questions (safety: the ride, the hour, the water) are disputed fiercely and conceded slowly, and **should** be, because they concern life.

The jurisdictional lever, in session: locate each disputed item's domain aloud, with the family, and negotiate the grant explicitly — the personal domain's items transferred on a schedule with a review, the prudential items kept with reasons stated in the language of protection rather than control, and the conventional items traded. "Whose question is this?" asked once, calmly, in a family session,

does more than an hour of communication-skills coaching, because it converts a values war into a boundary negotiation in which both parties can win.

The evidence qualifications, stated honestly: conflict frequency is a weak predictor of adjustment; conflict **quality** — hostility, contempt, withdrawal, unrepairable rupture — predicts; and repair predicts better than either, because the household that repairs teaches the adolescent that rupture is survivable, which is the single most transferable lesson of family life.

Lecture III — Parenting's evidence, its cultures, and its casualties

The two dials. Warmth/responsiveness and demandingness/structure crossed: authoritative (high-high) associates with the best adolescent outcomes across many samples; authoritarian (low warmth, high demand) with compliance and with internalising distress and covert behaviour; permissive (high warmth, low demand) with poorer self-regulation; neglectful (low-low) with the worst outcomes of all. The cultural qualification matters and is not decorative: directiveness carries different meanings in different communities — in many African, Asian and diaspora households, high structure with high warmth is normative and produces the same outcomes as "authoritative" measured with Western instruments, and importing a foreign family into a counselling room is a form of malpractice dressed as evidence. The counsellor assesses the two dials in the household's own idiom: where is the warmth, and is the structure warm? — not whether the style matches a scale.

The family presentations that end counselling-as-usual — where the developmental frame must give way to protection, grief or crisis work, and the week 13 pathway opens: *maltreatment* (abuse and neglect: the child's safety governs, the report follows the jurisdiction's law, and the counselling that pretends the household is a negotiation partner is a betrayal); *loss and separation* (death, divorce, migration splits — the adolescent's grief with its anger-mask and its school-collapse); *parental illness* (including the adolescent as carer: the child running the household at fourteen is not "mature", and the file says so); *displacement* (refugee, internally displaced, the twice-moved child whose belonging portfolio is all losses); and *household economies under strain* (the hunger in the house, the school fees, the work that competes with school — week 10's material, arriving early and governing everything else). In every one of these, the developmental renegotiation continues underneath, and the counselling that ignores either level — the crisis or the adolescence — fails the child twice.

> **SAFEGUARDING AND DUTY TO REPORT**
> Family work with adolescents carries the confidentiality geometry the adolescent must know before the first joint session: what each party has said in individual

sessions is not the counsellor's to release; joint sessions are prepared with each participant beforehand, and nothing is ambushed in the room. Where maltreatment is disclosed, the jurisdiction's child-protection law governs, the child is told what must happen and in what order, and the accompaniment principle of week 7 applies: the child goes with an adult, not to one.

Worked example 8.1 — The Ada household at the table

Task. First joint session: Auntie Bisi, Ada (14), and the counsellor. Bisi's opening statement: "She does not talk to me any more. I have done everything for her since her mother left." Plan the session: seating, order, lever, agreement.

Solution. *Preparation, before the room:* Ada seen first, alone; her words gathered and her permission taken for what may be said ("the choir, the nights — yes; the SS3 plan — not yet"); Bisi seen second, alone, and given the same rule: nothing ambushed. *Seating and order:* not across a table but beside and angled; Ada speaks first in the joint session — not because she is the client-of-record but because the household's story ("she does not talk") must be answered by the person it describes, in the room, once, before the adults' account organises everything. *The lever, located aloud:* the disputed items surface — the phone at night (prudential-personal boundary: the hour is negotiable, the charging outside the bedroom is the household's sleep rule for **everyone**, which Bisi accepts for herself in the room, converting control into shared practice); the SS3 plan (personal domain, deferred: Ada's jurisdiction, granted in principle with a review at the term's end, which Bisi hears as a schedule rather than a loss); the mother (nobody's jurisdiction to negotiate: loss, and the session names it once — "this table has three people and a fourth who is missing" — because the renegotiation cannot proceed around an unspoken hole). *The one agreement that survives the room:* the market errand — one standing weekly errand together, chosen because it is connection without interrogation, knowledge-supply without surveillance: what Ada tells on the walk home is voluntary, and voluntary telling is the monitoring that works. *Documentation:* jurisdictions located; the one agreement; Ada's knowledge of what was said about her; review in three weeks; and the sentence the file keeps — Bisi's "everything for her" and Ada's silence are both accurate, and the counselling is for the table, not the diagnosis.

Worked example 8.2 — Kelvin's household: structure without warmth, warmth without structure

Task. Kelvin (16, repeating SS1, one arrest) lives with Auntie Bisi and younger cousins. Bisi is warm and exhausted; the late father's brother supplies monthly rankings (week 6) and no warmth; the peer set supplies both structure and warmth outside the house. Assess the dials; write the household plan.

Solution. *Dial assessment, in the household's idiom:* warmth — present but stretched thin across four children and a trade, and Kelvin's share arrives as worry rather as pride; structure — outsourced: the rankings supply standards without warmth (the reliable risk), the peer set supplies both (why it governs his evenings), and the household supplies neither consistently for Kelvin specifically — not from neglect but from exhaustion and from the cultural assumption that a sixteen-year-old boy is already grown. *The three autonomies:* behavioural granted early and unhelpfully (he runs his own evenings at sixteen — authority without scaffolding); emotional under-developed toward the household (Bisi is loved but not confided in: the knowledge-supply stopped when the repeating began and the rankings made telling dangerous); cognitive autonomy healthy — he argues well, which the rankings punish and the room recruits. *Plan:* structure returned to the house in warm form — one weekly meal at which Kelvin's **effort** is read aloud (the rankings' slot, week 6′s substitution) and the football's pride announced; knowledge-supply reopened by one walk per month with Bisi in which results are forbidden (week 6′s uncle walk transplanted to the person who is actually warm); the code-message kept as willing transmission (week 4); the peer structure honoured rather than fought — one set member invited to the house for the match, converting the set from rival institution to guest; and the arrest's meaning held at the level it belongs: prudential domain, the household's authority legitimate, Kelvin's ownership of it the work — with the bag-on-the-windowsill principle stated to Bisi once: heat needs friction removed, and the removal is a household act, not a punishment. *Falsifier, dated:* books home within four weeks (week 6′s marker), and one voluntary telling — something Kelvin reports unprompted — within six. If the voluntary telling does not come, the knowledge-supply is blocked at the rankings and the uncle conversation reopens before anything else.

SKILLS LABORATORY

Practical 8 — the first family session. In triads (adolescent, parent, counsellor) with supplied case material: prepare each party separately, seat the room, run twenty minutes with the jurisdictional lever located aloud and exactly one agreement reached, then debrief against the record: whose story organised the room, what was ambushed, what survived. Rotate all roles. 400-word session record. The mark is for the adolescent having spoken first and the agreement being one the adolescent chose.

ASSESSMENT

Assessed task. A family case analysis of 1,200 words: the three autonomies assessed separately; the knowledge-supply located (what has the child stopped telling, and why); the disputed items mapped by domain with the jurisdictional lever written as you would say it aloud; the two dials assessed in the household's idiom with

cultural qualifications stated; the crisis presentations screened; and the first-session plan with seating, order, one agreement, and the confidentiality geometry stated to the adolescent.

Criterion	Weight
Autonomies separate; knowledge-supply located	20%
Domains mapped; lever phrased aloud	25%
Dials in the household's idiom, culture honoured	20%
Crisis screen complete	10%
Session plan concrete; confidentiality geometry stated	25%

Formative. Write the sentence you would say aloud, in a family session, to locate the jurisdiction of a sixteen-year-old's hair. Then write the parent's likely answer, and your next sentence.

UNIT SYNTHESIS

Synthesis. The adolescent family renegotiates rather than separates: emotional, behavioural and cognitive autonomy develop at three speeds, granted and refused in unchosen bundles; monitoring works through knowledge and knowledge through willing telling; conflict concentrates in the personal domain and its jurisdictional location is the lever that turns a values war into a negotiation, with conflict quality and repair predicting adjustment rather than frequency; parenting runs on two dials assessed in the household's own idiom, warmth the non-negotiable one; connectedness is the protection to preserve first; and where maltreatment, loss, illness, displacement or hunger governs, the crisis work opens and the adolescence continues underneath — the counselling that ignores either level fails the child twice.

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Seminar questions

1. "She does not talk to me any more." Who speaks first in the joint session, and why does the order matter more than the technique?
2. Locate the domain: a girl's hair; a boy's ride home at midnight; a child's church; a daughter's career. Which negotiations does your list make possible?
3. Authoritative parenting's cultural qualification: what is imported when a counsellor teaches it uncritically, and what is the household's own idiom for warm structure?
4. Knowledge comes mostly from willing telling. What has your service done that teaches adolescents not to tell?
5. The adolescent as carer: at what point is "mature" the wrong word, and what does the file say instead?

Next week

Week 9 moves outward: peers, crowds, romance and sexual development — the second institution of adolescence, with its own map, its own risks and its own counsel.

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